

The Questions of Vimalaprabha (Stainless Light)

Vimalaprabhāparipṛcchā · Toh 168 · Derge Kangyur

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The Questions of Vimalaprabha, known in Sanskrit as the Vimalaprabhāparipṛcchā and in Tibetan as Dri ma med pa'i 'od kyis zhus pa, is a sūtra in which the bodhisattva or deity Vimalaprabha — Stainless Light — poses questions to the Buddha in the context of a grand celestial assembly. The text opens with the Buddha teaching the Essence of the Moon sūtra on Vulture Peak, summoning gods and yakṣa kings including the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, situating the discourse within a cosmologically rich setting that suggests connections to lunar and calendrical themes found in related tantric literature. As a question-and-answer sūtra framed around divine interlocutors and protective deities, it belongs to the broader sūtra literature of the Kangyur. It is catalogued as Toh 168 in the Kangyur, where it appears among the general sūtra collections.

In the language of India: Vimalaprabhāparipṛcchā. In the Tibetan language: The Questions of Vimalaprabha — Stainless Light. First fascicle.

Homage to the Omniscient One.

At the time when the Buddha, the Blessed One, was teaching the sūtra called the Essence of the Moon, he entrusted each of the protectors of all the lands of Jambudvīpa with their respective duties, and while he was dwelling on Vulture Peak he sent forth rays of light in order to summon all the gods.

As soon as the Blessed One had directed his intention, all the kings of the gods, together with their retinues, appeared in the presence of the Blessed One. At that time the Blessed One called out to the Great King Vaiśravaṇa and to Sarvajaya, the lord of the yakṣas, and declared: "O Great Kings, attend to me in accordance with my Dharma teachings. One hundred years after I have passed into nirvāṇa, a land called Li will arise. I am entrusting it to your care."

O King Vaiśravaṇa, you,
and Sarvajaya of great miraculous power,
and Anavatapta, king of the nāgas,
and the son of the gods of steadfast and excellent intellect —
hear my words.

This land will be tamed by the power of the Victor alone,
and not by another.

The sentient beings I have not yet tamed
will take birth in the environs of the land of Li,
in the city prophesied by the Buddha.
For the sake of my enlightenment as a buddha,
they endured great suffering
and planted vast and numerous aspirational prayers —
and by that accumulation of merit,
this land has become a sign of my presence.
When I pass peacefully into nirvāṇa,
I entrust it to you.

At the time when the land of Li,
this ground of my loving-kindness, arises,
the buddhas of the fortunate aeon
will tame beings here in that time,
at the beautiful place called Agumatira,
at the stūpa of the Dharma king.
For the sake of fully protecting this land,
I now give it into your keeping.

Then King Vaiśravaṇa addressed a petition to the Blessed One:

O guide, the command of the buddhas
is not something one can comply with singly.
The supreme Victor has declared this task to be exceedingly difficult.
Even while the Teacher, the Blessed One, dwells,
quarrels arise in these various lands and regions.
When you teach the true Dharma,
those who fully guard it are rare —
how much more so when the Teacher has passed into nirvāṇa,
in lands abandoned by the gods,
where the protectors, gods and others,
do not follow your instructions?
Have compassion upon us.
Please teach such a Dharma as, when heard,
will cause all the gods to act according to your command.
The word of the buddhas, the heroes,
cannot be overturned on this earth.
Since performing a deed never done before by any being

is exceedingly difficult,
how shall we fully guard and protect that Blessed One?
The buddhas see through the three times;
they possess the eye of omniscient wisdom.
It is for the sake of that Victor, the supreme being,
that we are present and make this request.
Therefore we will bear in mind the trust you place in us.
We beseech your blessing so that we may perform
the task exactly as the Victor previously commanded.
In the city prophesied by the Victor —
in that city prophesied by the Victor of old —
the bodhisattvas,
and three hundred monks maintaining fine form and their vows,
and two hundred nuns will appear.
And those five hundred who engage in wrongdoing,
who in former times planted aspirational prayers
mixed with evil deeds —
those too will arise.

In order to obstruct the one who creates virtue,
they will take birth in these very lands.
Yet those dear friends of the one who creates virtue
will also take birth in the land of Li.
In the lands prophesied by the Victor,
they will perform what is excellent.
How we may come to be established in this land,
and by what means we may hold fast to it —
O Blessed One, we make this supreme supplication to you.

To this the Blessed One replied, granting the supreme and holy gift:

"O lord of the yakṣas, in order to guard this land completely at all times,
hold this excellent abode of the bodhisattvas fast by my words.
That land, when it arises, will be like the finest pleasure grove of the gods,
beautified by the Saṅgha's assembly halls and fragrant bathing chambers,
filled with joy through monasteries and parks.
The hermitages and retreat places there will become like Sukhāvatī itself.
Filled with monks and nuns, they will teach the supreme vehicle.
Those who are born as humans in that excellent abode of the bodhisattvas

will perform virtuous actions and dedicate them toward awakening.
For as long as the Mighty Sage (Śākyamuni) keeps his teaching present in that land
and people make offerings to it, so long will those lands endure.
But if offerings are not made to the teaching, the guardian spirits will be disturbed.
The land will be cast aside, and its inhabitants will wander in disturbed minds.
When the guardians have gone and the gods have abandoned this land,
it will be threatened by sickness and famine, and even the kings will be short-lived.
When all the guardians are enraged, they will bring even armies to nothing."

Having thus spoken to the gods, the most holy Victor, the supreme one, then entered into the meditative absorption (samādhi) called Glorious Rays of Light. From between his eyebrows there came forth rays of light called the Form of the Tathāgata. From those rays there arose countless and immeasurable further rays of light, which traveled throughout all the buddha-fields. In whichever buddha-field a blessed buddha was present, this declaration was uttered aloud: "Does the God of Gods, the blessed buddha Śākyamuni, suffer little? Does he move about well?" — and so on in that manner of inquiry. And this too was said: "For the sake of buddhahood itself, I have endured hardship over many aeons. In order to gather the authentic Dharma, I have given up uncountable bodies and offered many gifts. I have undergone immense suffering that other bodhisattvas have not experienced, and thereby attained unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Now the time and occasion of my passing into complete nirvāṇa has arrived, and so that all the lands of Jambudvīpa may be well maintained, I have placed them in the hands of the guardians."

When I, the gods, have passed beyond sorrow,
at the time when one hundred years have passed,
a land bearing the name of Li
shall prosperously arise.
It will be a hook for the taming
of the buddhas of the Fortunate Aeon
and of the protecting bodhisattvas —
free from mere speculation.
The Victors' children of the Fortunate Aeon

will also take birth in that city at the heart of Li,
and will appear there like eyes,
to ripen sentient beings
and that the Dharma may be heard.
At that time they will all engage
in the excellent conduct of the bodhisattva.
Let the buddhas look upon me with care:
when this great sūtra, the Heart of the Sun,
this supreme sūtra, is being taught,
with a mind overcome by compassion,
in order to guard that land,
dhāraṇī mantras and rays of light —

Just as before they sent forth emanations,
from every buddha-field throughout all worlds,
those who have taken birth in this land —
may the supreme Victors send them forth.
To guard the teaching may they send them forth,
send them forth to me with joyful hearts.

When the protector, Śākyamuni, the Lion of the Śākyas,
sends out those rays of light,
they go to all the buddha-fields
and then return again to that very place.

Then, at once, the Blessed One buddhas dwelling in all the buddha-fields,
wishing to fully protect the land of Li on behalf of the Blessed One Śākyamuni,
and so that the teaching might long endure, sent rays of light into the land and
also transmitted dhāraṇī mantras, speaking thus:

"The names of those Blessed One buddhas who sent out rays of light and
transmitted dhāraṇī mantras into the hands of the bodhisattvas are as follows,
and the names of those bodhisattvas are as follows.

Homage to the Tathāgata who is bold in entering among all non-Buddhists
(tīrthikas).

Homage to the bodhisattva of the secret word.

The dhāraṇī mantra is: tadyathā — bara bara kāśa ara cakra koṣe
guhyakabāre svāhā.

Through this dhāraṇī mantra, the holy gods will bestow blessings upon the gods and humans of the land of Li.

Homage to the Tathāgata who is bold in the Dharma of joy.

Homage to the bodhisattva who is the lord of the Dharma.

Tadyathā — bara trika buli śa siri pahāre bāre svāhā.

Through this dhāraṇī mantra one will come to recall past lives.

Homage to the speech of the Tathāgata, the supremely noble crest of one who has entered upon the Dharma.

Homage to the bodhisattva Īśvara of the world (Avalokiteśvara).

Homage to the bodhisattva of words that are luminous in one's own mind.

Homage to the Tathāgata, the supremely exalted king.

Homage to the bodhisattva of the word of space.

Tadyathā — hvākyarate ho ho ho ho phāru rara abibara mabibara ṇaruhe svāhā.

Whoever holds this dhāraṇī mantra will not go to the lower realms and the evil destinies, and will come to know how the migrations of sentient beings were in previous lives and what they will be in lives to come.

Homage to the Tathāgata Priyajaya, whose Dharma grows and flourishes.

Homage to the bodhisattva who is lord of the Dharma for gods and humans.

Tadyathā — dharasthita tathatāvajri bisare tathatā svāhā.

Through this dhāraṇī mantra one will attain the dhāraṇī.

Homage to the Tathāgata Akṣobhya (the Unshakeable).

Homage to the bodhisattva who is the stainless lord.

Tadyathā — avahi sarvatathāgatabhūtaḥkoṭi bhatibhati paḍiraḍi svāhā.

Through this dhāraṇī mantra one will attain awakening at the foot of the bodhi tree of the Tathāgatas.

Homage to the Tathāgata, the King of the Sound of Drums.

Homage to the bodhisattva Śrīgyan (Glorious Ornament).

Tadyathā — tathatāpuḍe dravane sarvisaraḍri guhyamantra tathatādhana svāhā.

Through this dhāraṇī mantra the bodhisattva will accomplish great austerities, and sentient beings will be utterly liberated from suffering and sickness.

Homage to the Tathāgata Amitābha.

Homage to the bodhisattva Nāṃsal (Illuminated Light).

Tadyathā — raddāgate bagribati taḍibhati candre svāhā.

Through this dhāraṇī mantra the bodhisattva will fully purify buddha-fields, and the physical and mental suffering of whoever holds this mantra will be exhausted."

Homage to the Tathāgata Śākyamuni.

Homage to the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, Youthful Prince of Wisdom.

Homage to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra.

Tadyathā — bhinare ribi samasacagaba darśana raśmi samanta darśarani svāhā.

Through this dhāraṇī mantra the bodhisattva will come to know all activities, and by it the Tathāgata Śākyamuni himself also performed great deeds. These buddhas, the Blessed Ones, transmitted this dhāraṇī mantra to the Blessed One Śākyamuni so that he might guard it in every land.

At that time the Blessed One, the buddha, entered into the meditative absorption known as the Courageous Advance, and from the first arising of his aspiration all the way to the heart of awakening, he fully and rightly contemplated with devotion all the conduct of a bodhisattva and all the Dharma. Then, for his own benefit and for the benefit of the gods and others, he entrusted and committed those lands to them.

As for the dhāraṇī mantra of all the gods, beginning with Brahmā, it too should be recited:

Namo brahmaṇe. Namaḥ sarvadebānān. Tadyathā — brahmaṇa indre devatāpratiṣṭhite aśvasthāne bara indre svaparapari harakṣiṃ maba indre santathāsmara bara hare ama bhakumbhaka krī grī śrī ālaṃkāra sarba deba grāma svāhā.

Through this dhāraṇī mantra gods and humans will attain victory; enemies will not be able to harm the one who holds it, and he will become lord of all sovereigns. Whoever is to become a king in the land of Li will think to himself: "This land of Li is filled with people, with men and women in great number, and abounds in wealth and grain. It is the highest and most excellent of all lands, and so no enemy army can come against it." At that time that king will cause the monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen, together with all the people of the land, throughout every hermitage, every garden of the Saṅgha, every city,

every village, every district, and all the surrounding areas of the royal palace, to read out the words of the dhāraṇī secret mantra described above, to take it up and to make it thoroughly known. And those monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen, and all the people dwelling in the land, shall be served and honored with flour, cloth, parasols, victory banners, flags, food, various drinks, various acts of offering, and all manner of requisites. They are to be treated with reverence, shown respect, and venerated. If this is done, that land of Li will be free of all harm, and no hostile king, with all his armies, will be able to destroy that king's land of Li.

Then again, from the buddha-fields of the ten directions, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, sent forth their respective names, their rays of light, and the words of their dhāraṇī mantras. The Blessed One Śākyamuni placed them into the hands of the thirty-two divine kings — Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), Brahmā, and the rest — and the four world-protectors, and the divine son Sarvatrojavijaya and his companions, and the twenty-eight great lords of the yakṣa hosts, and the bodhisattva Vimalaprabha (Stainless Light), and those twenty thousand bodhisattvas who offer worship at the stūpa of Gomasalagandha, and the eighteen thousand nāga kings headed by Takṣaka the Proud — into all their hands — along with the abode of all the bodhisattvas of this Fortunate Aeon.

It was entrusted to them so that they might protect, fully sustain, and keep from harm the region of Li, the stūpa of Gomasalagandha — which has become the emblem of all the buddhas of the Fortunate Aeon, the Blessed Ones, and the abode of the great sage — together with the communities of monks and nuns there, so that none would be scattered, and so that the Buddha's teaching established in the region of Li might long endure. These names of the buddhas, these rays of light, and these dhāraṇī mantra syllables were presented as gifts, filled with compassionate intent and sent forth with great supplication. And so, in accordance with the command of those Blessed Ones the buddhas, Śakra, Brahmā, and the rest — all thirty-two divine kings, those world-protectors, those lords of the yakṣa hosts, those nāga kings, the bodhisattvas headed by Vimalaprabha, and all those in that assembly — joined their palms in reverence and pledged to protect the region of Li, the stūpa of Gomasalagandha which is the abode of the great sage, and those teachings of the Buddha. They likewise pledged to protect those names of the buddhas, those rays of light, and those dhāraṇī mantra syllables for the sake of guarding the land. And those rays of light came to abide within the body of the

bodhisattva Vimalaprabha.

Homage to the Tathāgata supremely dwelling in moral discipline.

Homage to the Tathāgata delighting in peace.

Homage to the Tathāgata who is the king of peace.

Homage to the Tathāgata who is the master of peace.

Homage to the Tathāgata supremely dwelling in space.

Homage to the Tathāgata who thoroughly swallows weapons.

Homage to the Tathāgata of a hundred eyes.

Homage to the Tathāgata of excellent rays of light.

Homage to the Tathāgata with the form of Indra.

Homage to the Tathāgata with the form of the sun.

The ray of light called Victory Banner of Indra, the ray of light called Leaf of Nectar, the ray of light called That Which Brings Peace, the ray of light called Free from Leaves, the ray of light called Ka, the ray of light called Fire, the ray of light called Abiding, the ray of light called Immovable, the ray of light called Moving and Immovable, the ray of light called Unobstructed Giving, the ray of light called Pleasing to the Mind, the ray of light called Unimpeded, the ray of light called Ten Million Victory Banners Free of Contagion, the ray of light called Undisturbed Abiding, the ray of light called Intelligence of the Pinnacle, the ray of light called Descending into the City, the ray of light called Wheel Illuminator, the ray of light called Hero's Pinnacle, the ray of light called Vajra Form, the ray of light called Pinnacle of Merit, the ray of light called Pinnacle of Meditative Concentration, the ray of light called Possessing Flames, the ray of light called Universally Illuminating, the ray of light called Limb of Awakening, the ray of light called Light of Calm Abiding, the ray of light called Boundless, the ray of light called Jewel Illuminator, the ray of light called Hero's Precious Gem, the ray of light called Moon Illuminator, the ray of light called Sun Illuminator, the ray of light called Wisdom Farer, the ray of light called Precious Illuminator, the ray of light called Victory Banner of Indra, the ray of light called World Illuminator, the ray of light called Form of Compassion, the ray of light called Noble Victor,

the ray of light called Wisdom Radiance, the ray of light called Fire, the ray of light called Lamp of the World, the ray of light called Fully Pacifying the Form of Cataracts, the ray of light called Supreme Victor, the ray of light called Form of the World, the ray of light called Great Light, the ray of light called Kokara, the ray of light called Acting in the Manner of A, the ray of light called Jatsaraya, the ray of light called Hero's Victory Banner of the Hero Who Makes

Heroes, the ray of light called Great Light, the ray of light called Boundless Light, the ray of light called Immovable, the ray of light called Victory Banner of Intelligence, the ray of light called Lofty Effort, the ray of light called Possessor of Truth, the ray of light called Gladdening, the ray of light called Loudly Proclaimed, the ray of light called Light Maker, the ray of light called Vajra Intelligence, the ray of light called Form of Emptiness, the ray of light called Holder, the ray of light called Queen of Heroes, the ray of light called Trembling, the ray of light called Going to the Higher Realms, the ray of light called Form of Peace, the ray of light called Crest of Peace, the ray of light called Victory Banner of Meditative Concentration, the ray of light called Crest of Joy, the ray of light called Light Like a Reed, the ray of light called Eye Illuminator, the ray of light called Nāga Arising, the ray of light called River Light, the ray of light called Form of a Person, the ray of light called Blazing, the ray of light called Fire, the ray of light called Lotus Light, the ray of light called Form of the Sense Faculties, the ray of light called Manner of Inquiry, the ray of light called Moving, the ray of light called Abiding in the Sense Faculties, the ray of light called Agitated, the ray of light called Displaying the Victory Banner of the Earth, the ray of light called Crest of Truth, the ray of light called Illuminating, the ray of light called Form of Tingling, the ray of light called Relying on the Sense Faculties, the ray of light called Going in the Mind, the ray of light called Beautifully Moving Forward, the ray of light called Form of Immediacy, the ray of light called Beautifully Blazing, the ray of light called Inquiring, the ray of light called Revolving Sun, the ray of light called Dwelling Near, the ray of light called Water of Wisdom, the ray of light called Intelligence of the Victor, the ray of light called Thoroughly Composed, the ray of light called Illuminating Truth, the ray of light called Form of a Buddha, the ray of light called Uṣṇīṣa, the ray of light called Vajra Victory Banner, the ray of light called Abiding in the Vajra, the ray of light called Victory Banner of Merit, the ray of light called Tongue Crest, the ray of light called Pleasing to the Mind. These are the rays of light of the buddha.

Tadyathā: loka hāra śuddha karusthiti puṣyava karule svāhā. This is called Severing Non-virtue.

Tadyathā: śuddhamati adzambhe bulotsa re akramate tsura kare pu svāhā. This is called Compassion That Brings Joy.

Tadyathā: indra indri badre bade biphu re svāhā.

This is called Vajra Wisdom.

Tadyathā: ṭha ke va ke, jā jambhe, bhra ma jva re svāhā. This is called Lotus Taming.

Tadyathā: śu ra, ra re ve a lo ke, ko śa gā re svāhā. This is called Differentiation.

Tadyathā: tsa le vi ta thā, a nyo nya, pra jñā kā re svāhā. This is called Without Effort.

Tadyathā: ji ji re, hā rā hā le, le le pra jñā kā re svāhā. This is called Without Cessation.

Tadyathā: va jre śrī ka re, sa ra sa ra, a jñā mā jñe, na ri re kī, na ri, saṃ gi jñā kā re phu svāhā. This is called Invincible.

Tadyathā: a pu rī vi va re, sa da re, ma kha ka re svāhā. This is called Abiding in Truth.

Tadyathā: jyo ti jyo ti, va jre a, a kṣa man tra ve, pra ga ā ve, va jri mā va, ka ka su re svāhā. This is called the Queen of Sovereign Dhāraṇī Mantras, and this dhāraṇī mantra pacifies the assembled forces of adversaries and brings to perfect completion the accumulation of virtue.

Tadyathā: di śā ka re, stha kā rai, in dra va te, va prā tau sa prā u sthā te svāhā. This dhāraṇī mantra eliminates famine and eliminates poverty. Moreover, the holy one will obtain all that is desired: if one recites it twenty-one times at each of eight sessions — four times by day and four times by night, making twenty-one recitations per session — one will obtain a treasure or other wealth hidden beneath the earth.

Tadyathā: oṃ he mo he jambha ya, ma śa man tra kā, da ma kā re la bhā kā re, vi kā re sa di jñā kā re, da ka di a dhā ka, pra śa ma na phu a ka na pra ma ne phu svāhā. This pacifies all illness, liberates one from rebirth as a woman, and thoroughly pacifies the illnesses specific to women. No ascetic discipline is required; one should recite it three times a day according to one's wish. For any woman who has an illness of the monthly sign, one should recite it seven times each day.

Tadyathā: ka ka, ko śa phu ma ma, ra ra ra ra, sta re phu, sa ka re phu svāhā. This dhāraṇī mantra is declared to eliminate harm that has arisen and all suffering. No ascetic discipline is required.

Now, those blessed buddhas whose names were mentioned above, and who taught these dhāraṇī mantras, were all companions of the Blessed One

Śākyamuni during his practice of the bodhisattva conduct. Those buddhas dwelt in the world-system of Endurance, and it is within this land of Liyul, the realm of the Blessed One Śākyamuni, and for the benefit of the many beings there. Taking birth as bodhisattvas of the Fortunate Aeon, those respective blessed buddhas, for the sake of causing the Blessed One Śākyamuni's Liyul to endure for a long time, sent gifts of those dhāraṇī mantras, those rays of light of the buddhas, and those names of the buddhas. The sons of the buddhas requested them, and then the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, for the sake of all sentient beings, for the protection of Liyul, and in order that the Dharma teaching might endure for a long time, took those gifts from the blessed buddhas and brought them here.

Furthermore, many bodhisattvas dwelling in various buddha-fields, in order that this land prophesied by the buddhas might not be destroyed and that the teaching might likewise endure for a long time, came here and took birth.

When harm befalls that land, the names of the buddhas, the dhāraṇī mantras, and the rays of light described above should be written and placed at the gates of the city. They should also be written and set upon the standards and weapons of the army. When the people are caused to read and to carry them, protection will be given from fear of enemy armies and from fear of famine; karma will be purified; the wholesome side will be fully perfected; and sentient beings will be benefited according to whatever they have wished for. They will also become a refuge for sentient beings who are sick. Even for those who bear very heavy evil karma, if they recite the names of the buddhas, the dhāraṇī mantras, and the rays of light for twenty-one days and call to mind the blessed buddhas of the ten directions, then before a stūpa that contains bodily relics, or in the presence of a buddha image, if this recitation is performed three times a day, whatever wholesome aim one desires will swiftly be fully perfected, and those rays of light will come to rest upon that person. If enemy armies approach, the recitation should be performed. Alternatively, it should be read for seven days. For anyone at all who has been harmed, who is sick, or who wishes to recite or to read according to any purpose whatsoever — these should be done. If one is unable to read, then the mantra should be recited seven times over a cord, knotted, and tied on, and one will be freed from all harm. Whatever city has the names of the buddhas, the dhāraṇī mantras, and the rays of light written and placed at its gates cannot be destroyed by enemy armies. For one who recites constantly, there is no need to abstain from meat, and there is no need to abstain from other things either.

Then, to those sons of good family who had gone forth in the wake of the buddhas and who were very scrupulous and filled with shame, the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara spoke these words: Children, do not be filled with shame. For your sake, many assembly halls of the Saṅgha, and perfume-houses and the like built by Dharma kings, together with stūpas containing relics, will arise in that land. For as long as the teaching of the blessed buddhas endures in that land, no king capable of destroying that entire land will arise. Likewise, those three — the one called Dṅgarldanpa, the beautiful one marked by the pig, and the old city — for as long as the teaching of the buddhas endures, and offerings are made to the entire Saṅgha, and the buddha stūpa is at Kapila, they will not be destroyed.

Then the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara called together all the sons of the Victors and enjoined them: Friends — all the bodhisattvas and gods and others who are guardians of that land — when a king without Dharma destroys that land, do not abandon it in despair. If some among you do not heed the word of the buddhas and, at the time of destruction, forsake the land, you will be obstructed for many aeons from attaining the unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening.

Then this dhāraṇī mantra was spoken: Tadyathā: kāle, akāle, niṣramebhapraveśā, ākālikrame, aniṣkrame, apraveśā, paresamepa risami ti, sasase, asasase, sakute, varure, parure, agame, asamamo te, siddhe siddhāya, namo vairocaṇāya svāhā, phaḍaḍeṇe svate, āsāte, sumanne, saruste, siddhe, siddhāya svāhā.

Then the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara questioned the one who had become king of Liyul:

"This is your birth. What you have done — offering up your body and life for the sake of the Three Jewels — is the very deed of the children of the buddhas. You have done well. Whenever a great and fearsome enemy threatens the land, this sūtra should be read, kept, and venerated. All fears will be pacified, and Sahāpati too will come to your aid. For the protection of the land, write out this sūtra according to the proper rite and keep it in the royal palace. Write it out as well and place it at the outer walls of the palace and at the gates of the city. Place it likewise on the great roads, the streets, at crossroads and intersections, and in the houses of householders. Whenever it is read many times, learned, or kept, that land will be freed from epidemic disease and all harm."

Having spoken thus, the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara fell silent. Then the gods dwelling in the sky let fall a rain of divine flowers, sounded divine cymbals, and beat great divine drums. And all the bodhisattvas, gods, and kings of the nāgas spoke these words: "Whenever those dhāraṇī mantras, those rays of light, and those names of buddhas come to that land, we too will come there continuously, just as we came before into the presence of the Blessed One Śākyamuni. For the protection of the king and that land, we will bestow dhāraṇī mantras, and we will bestow whatever sacred things are requested."

Then a bodhisattva who was dwelling in a buddha-field called "Adorned Individually by the Light Rays of Vairocana, in a Female Form," made an aspirational prayer before the Tathāgata whose name is "The Fully Blossoming Flower of Direct Realization, the Stainless Star-King of the Lotus Petal," praying thus: "May I come to the world-realm of Sahā, the buddha-field of the Blessed One Śākyamuni, and there may I hear from that Blessed One the doctrinal category known as the White Lotus of the True Dharma. And there may I bring to all sentient beings benefit, happiness, and freedom from illness."

Having made this aspiration, that bodhisattva passed away from that buddha-field and was reborn in the world-realm of Sahā, in the palace of King Ajātaśatru, as a noble daughter of the queen, and she was called Stainless Light.

Then that very one who had become the daughter of King Ajātaśatru — she called Stainless Light — was present, gathered within that assembly. She addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, one hundred years after you have passed into complete nirvāṇa, I too wish to be entrusted with the commission to protect the land of Liyul. When the rays of light which you, the buddha, the Blessed One, previously sent forth come to rest upon me, may I receive in female form the dhāraṇī through which all dhāraṇīs are understood. Whenever great fear arises in Liyul, so that I may fully protect the land and cause the teaching to abide for a long time, may the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, turn their attention to me, may they show me the means, and may the gods bestow their sacred gifts. And may I, appearing there as a woman, appear in that ordinary female form, indistinguishable from other human women."

May I also come to rest upon those rays of light of the buddhas. For the sake of freeing those sentient beings who are threatened by harm, those who are

struck by illness, and those who have fallen into suffering — from all their suffering — may I also obtain those dhāraṇī mantras. Whenever those great kings wage war against one another, and whenever the Red-Faced Ones carry off the districts of Liyul, may I take birth there in female form. May I also uphold the sacred Dharma of the noble sūtra of the Great Vehicle, the White Lotus, as proclaimed by the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. May I also understand the dhāraṇī mantras that arise from this sūtra. For the sake of taming sentient beings, may I also attain the meditative absorption of understanding all sounds. Through the categories of Dharma of the sacred White Lotus may I bring benefit to all sentient beings. And to the gods who are protectors of Liyul, may I perform the gift of Dharma and acts of offering. May this noble sūtra of the Great Vehicle, the White Lotus, and those gods who have taught and upheld this sūtra, also come under my authority.

Then the protector Vaiśravaṇa, all the rākṣasī Lamakontī, and all the rākṣasīs together with their companions, and Haritī together with her retinue — all of these, having heard the words of the Blessed One and of the goddess Vimalaprabha, rose from their seats, joined their palms, and spoke thus: "When this goddess takes birth in Liyul, at that time we too, in order to assist her, will act as protectors and will bear in mind that you have entrusted to her the sacred Dharma of the noble sūtra of the Great Vehicle, the White Lotus, and the districts of Liyul."

Then the king of the gods of the Thirty-Two, upon hearing this vow of the goddess, spoke thus: "When this goddess takes birth in order to protect Liyul, we too, together with our retinue, will assist, protecting that land and ensuring that all she intends comes to fruition."

Then the goddess Vimalaprabha rose from her seat, arranged her upper robe over one shoulder, placed her right knee on the ground, joined her palms, made her vow before the Blessed One, and offered this aspiration prayer in the presence of the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, may I come to regard all sentient beings as though they were my only child. May everything I undertake with diligence come to fruition. May I be steadfast in body and steadfast in mind, may I work for the benefit of sentient beings, may I fulfil all intentions completely, and may I strive with full dedication of mind for the sake of the land. May I bring benefit to sentient beings through the sūtra of the sacred White Lotus, and may I also attain meditative absorption."

The goddess spoke thus in the presence of the Blessed One. At that moment, a rain of divine flowers fell upon the Blessed One and upon the goddess Vimalaprabha.

At that time the goddess Vimalaprabha,
that fair abode of a bodhisattva,
made her aspiration prayer before the Victor,
praying: "May I be born in Liyul!

For as long as the teaching
of the Protector, the Śākya Lion, Śākyamuni, endures,
for so long may I too
continuously take birth there.

When the goddess made her aspiration prayer
before the Victor,
the Victors dwelling in buddha-fields
then declared: 'Excellent!'

To the goddess, guardian of the land —

granted their blessing by the Victors,
Vaiśravaṇa, lord of yakṣas,
and Kuntū Gyalwa likewise heard.

Then Vaiśravaṇa and the other
gods who were assembled there
addressed the Blessed One with these words:
"In order to protect Liyul,
we noble and excellent gods have agreed,
and we too shall take this land under our care.
When the golden clans
and the jewel lands grown beautiful
come under the dominion of Li,
a golden tribute shall be measured out."

Then the goddess made this address:

"For the sake of guarding
the jewel lands and the golden clans,
O Victor, best of the noble-born, please grant this boon:
in a former life upon this earth,
when I was a laywoman
by the name of Hushar,

these two lands were mine.

And the king who arose as their sovereign in that time
was Orgyen's lord, the Powerful One.

Now the king rises from his throne,
places both knees upon the ground,
and addresses the Blessed One:

'At the time when what is called Liyul
comes into being and fully flourishes,
with its people thriving,
may I then, in the jewel lands,
become a great and powerful king,
always be an ally to the lord of Li,
protect my own land,
and offer myself in its service.'

At that time the goddess Vimalaprabha
uttered this aspiration prayer:

'When the Sumpas in great number come to this land,
when the Chinese, the A-zha, and the Sumpas
come to this land like the army of a noble warrior king,
at that time, for the sake of the people of this land,
may I take birth here.

By my taking birth there,
may the Sumpas and the rest be turned back.

In the settlements of Liyul,
wherever the people formerly performed their duties,
there too may I joyfully
perform those very same duties.

There, may the former kings,
ministers, householders, and ordinary people
who were dear to me
not be separated from me.

At that time, alone and sorrowful,
having attained a foul meditative absorption,
when I fall into dejection there,
may I recall my former aspiration prayers.'

At that time, among his retinue,
the king of Kaspara,
having heard what the goddess Vimalaprabha had said,
rose from his throne
and spoke these words:
'In my former lives
I performed unbearable deeds,
going together with the noble warrior king
to the lovely lands in order to destroy the Śākyas.
May I not experience in this very life
the terrible ripening of those actions.
I make this aspiration prayer:
at the time when the Sumpas and A-zha go there,
and when it is the deeds I formerly performed on the battlefield of the noble
warriors in the land of the Śākyas — at the time when this goddess falls into
great sorrow, may I be present on her behalf, may I feel sorrow for her sake,
and just as one who has first received a dhāraṇī, may I thereby be freed from
all suffering.'

The noble queen of that king, who was sitting in that very assembly and had
made that aspiration prayer, then thought: 'I too have been a servant of the
goddess Vimalaprabha. I turned back the army of the noble warriors, and
having performed such a great evil deed, what shall I do?' Through the
virtuous mind that arose from that doubt, she made this aspiration: 'May I, in
that very land of Liyul, before the moment of my death, see impermanence in
that same land of Liyul, and when the A-zha and Sumpas come to that land,
may I, having reached the time of death, be born in the realm of bliss,
Sukhāvatī.'

The nephew of the goddess Vimalaprabha — he who was the son of King
Ajātaśatru — was exceedingly arrogant and proud, and he came to that battle
of the Śākyas to watch the fighting, arriving as a companion to the army of the
noble warrior Ajātaśatru. There too he committed evil deeds such as killing
people in that battle. When he saw the many sentient beings who had died
there, he saw a buddha and was seized with great remorse and grief. At that
time he said to the goddess Vimalaprabha: "I am your dear nephew, and I
have committed evil deeds in that army. When you hear this, you will be
pleased — and through that act of your mind rejoicing in unwholesome deeds,
the karmic maturation of that action will bring the army of the Sumpas to your

land. At that time, as now, I shall have become your beloved nephew once more. You alone, without any scriptural basis, will attain an absorption that is impure, and it will be as though you have obtained a dhāraṇī from the very beginning. At that time, through your power, I too will be freed from the sufferings of hell-beings and animals, and I will become the yakṣa named Āju, a servant of the yakṣa lord Vaiśravaṇa's son. He will constantly protect you, and through me, Vaiśravaṇa's son and those others, and those other yakṣas, will be reminded of the divine kings in the thirty-two divine palaces — and when the time comes that you think of this, may everything you wish be accomplished." So he spoke.

Then the youngest sister of that same goddess, she who had become the daughter of King Ajātaśatru, made this aspiration: "I heard that my nephew committed evil deeds as a companion to the army of the noble warrior Ajātaśatru, and I felt joy at hearing this. Through that deed, I too will again be your younger sister in that place. And when the karmic maturation of that deed causes me to die a sorrowful death, may you, being saddened in just such a way, lead me to find a spiritual friend, and having heard the Dharma of such a kind that through it one attains the first fruit and brings suffering to an end, may I at that time remember my past and future deeds." So she made her prayer.

Now the youngest nephew of that goddess — he who had become the laywoman named Huśa — he whose past karma caused sentient beings to tremble, saw his sister making an aspiration prayer before the Blessed One, and saw her, having made that aspiration before the Blessed One, commit herself to the task of fully protecting the land of Liyul.

Then the youngest nephew of the goddess Vimalaprabha, the son of King Ajātaśatru, bowed with joined palms toward where the Blessed One was seated and spoke these words: "In former times I attended upon many buddhas, the Blessed Ones, and in every birth I took, I also performed many royal duties. This my sister, though in a woman's body, conducts the conduct of a bodhisattva. That she undertook hardship for the sake of fully protecting the land of Liyul — this is indeed a great deed, and I beg of you: the intention of a woman is known to none but the Buddha, the Blessed One himself. May the Blessed One, sending rays of light down upon me just so, grant me your blessing. May I in every way become a helper in guarding the land."

"May you also grant a dhāraṇī of such a kind that my lineage will for a long time become the holders of Liyul. And having taken birth and attained the fruit, may I, even after passing away, be reborn among the gods. And when the time comes that the Sumpa or the Red-Faces arrive in Liyul, may I at that time have become the king of the land of Kardo, and the brother of the goddess Vimalaprabhā, and may I act as her companion in causing Liyul to flourish." Thus he spoke and also set forth this aspiration. At that moment the Blessed One entered into the meditative absorption known as "Victorious Over Māra." The gods, too, let fall a rain of divine flowers and sounded the divine cymbals.

The Blessed One arose from that meditative absorption and declared: "All the vast accumulations of merit I have gathered — from the first arousal of the awakening mind up to the time of dwelling at the seat of awakening — together with the great heaps of merit accrued by all the many other Tathāgatas through their manifold buddha-activities performed each in their own way, and all those miraculous powers — all of these I have gathered into one and sealed into one, so that in the future, for the full protection of this goddess Vimalaprabhā, the land and its surroundings of Liyul, taken in hand, shall be made to stand firm and endure."

Then the Blessed One became invisible on Vulture Peak Mountain and took his place in the direction from which Liyul and the great sage's dwelling, the stūpa of Gomasalagandha, would arise. While the Blessed One was dwelling there, he entered into the meditative absorption known as "Adorned by All Glory" and sent forth rays of light called the "Lamp of Wisdom." And the entire retinue dwelling on Vulture Peak, even while remaining in that single place, beheld the Blessed One seated in crossed-legged posture in the very direction from which Liyul would arise.

The bodhisattvas who had formerly been companions of the Blessed One Śākyamuni when he was practicing the bodhisattva conduct — those who dwelt at the great sage's mountain called Rilangu — also sent forth those rays of light, and the Blessed One himself was seen abiding in the sky above the place where the wheel of Dharma of the stūpa of Gomasalagandha would arise. The bodhisattvas took their positions each upon a lotus in the water, in those very places from which the Saṅgha's assembly halls and the dwelling places of hermitages and bathhouses and great stūpas would arise.

Then there the buddha, the Blessed One, taught this dhāraṇī mantra, called "The Summit of All Dharmas," by which all the Dharmas of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, are taken to heart:

Tadyathā — babara, pratyababara, prajñābabara, buddhababara, saddharma-babara, śūrābabara, sarvadharmaskandhababara, vajrapāṇibabara, tiṣṭhata babara svāhā.

When the buddha, the Blessed One, had taught this dhāraṇī mantra, the entire retinue dwelling on Vulture Peak heard it. And on the peak of Rilangu they also beheld the Blessed One seated together with the assembly of all the bodhisattvas.

Then the Blessed One addressed the goddess Vimalaprabhā and the youth Vajrasena: "You, by means of this dhāraṇī mantra, shall act on my behalf, and since the land and its surroundings of Liyul are entrusted to you, guard them fully." At that time the goddess Vimalaprabhā and —

The bodhisattva Vajrasena spoke these words: "Blessed One, we shall accept and uphold this entrustment of Liyul."

The Questions of Vimalaprabhā. The Second Fascicle.

At that time, for the sake of the goddess Vimalaprabhā and the youth Vajrasena, the Blessed One taught another dhāraṇī mantra:

tadyathā, nirjite, brjite, brjite, bhaṭite dharmaskandhaabarajite, indrabrjite, phu svāhā.

At that time, the buddha Ratnagarbha and the others before whom the goddess Vimalaprabhā had first aroused the mind set upon buddhahood — they too came there. And the youth Vajrasena made offerings. From the buddha, the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Samantadarśin, she received a prophecy of future buddhahood. Vimalaprabhā will attain awakening in the buddha field called King of Light, and she will become a Tathāgata named Dhvajacandrasuprabharaśmiprabhārāja — the King of the Rays of the Supremely Lofty Moon-Banner. In the age called Sthita, in the world system known as Celebrated by Women, there will appear a Tathāgata named Dharmaghoṣa Ratnakoṣahasta — Proclaimer of the Dharma-Sound, Bearing a Jewel Treasury in Hand.

When the Blessed One thus gave this prophecy to the goddess, and in order to seal that prophecy the Blessed One sent forth rays of light — when the goddess Vimalaprabhā received that prophecy, she became known at that

very moment as Bodhisattva Semkyi Tsik, and from then on the blessed buddhas dwelling in all buddha fields also gave her prophecies. The bodhisattvas of the Fortunate Aeon likewise declared: "The awakening in which you abide is exceedingly rare."

Then all the blessed buddhas who were at that time sending forth rays of light toward the Blessed One Śākyamuni spoke together with one voice, reciting this dhāraṇī mantra:

tadyathā, tātātā, lokāgra, tathāgata, kavapavi, karaji, bhūtaḥ, vividrakhaśara, sas sas sas sas, bhadhāprabhā, vapadakarana, varanavabavaba, asacarunana, capavaraṇa, kākakottarājāna, vyākaraṇasabhadra, karaṇa svāhā.

This dhāraṇī mantra is called the Prophecy Mantra. By means of this dhāraṇī, the blessed buddhas bestow upon bodhisattvas a prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. If it is recited three times at night and three times during the day, one becomes irreversible and will also receive a prophecy of buddhahood.

When the goddess Vimalaprabhā received the prophecy of her future buddhahood, she at that moment attained great patience. And at that moment she set forth this aspiration: "For as long as great dangers arise in the land of Liyul, may I appear in female form, and through this aspiration may I then take birth as a daughter of the King of Karādu." She prostrated herself before the Tathāgata Dhvajacandrasuprabharaśmiprabhārāja, and before the Tathāgata Dharmaghoṣa Ratnaśaṣṭha. Whoever recites these two buddha names will be liberated from birth as a woman and will take birth in that world system. Whatever the noble venerable one desires will be fulfilled accordingly. And the karmas leading to birth in the hells will be purified through confession.

One will become irreversible from unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening. Sadyāthedan. Da da da da. Prajñāke sa. Prajñāke re. Para prajñā. Prata ha ta svāhā. This dhāraṇī mantra is called "Flower of the Limbs of Awakening." Whatever Dharma one desires, one will accordingly attain. The gods of the māra's host will be unable to create obstacles to one's pursuit of buddhahood and will find no opportunity to do so. One will come to possess mindfulness, and one's mind will not become inverted.

At the time when the buddha, the Blessed One, was expounding this dhāraṇī mantra, the goddess Vimalaprabha made an aspiration: "May I take birth there, become a daughter of the King of Karādu, and go to that golden land

where I have been made sorrowful by the suffering of the loss of my parents." At that time, there was in that assembly another young man of good family who was a guardian of the city of King Ajātaśatru, and he spoke these words: "Become my householder, and in my home you may perform those activities in a woman's body. I will not create obstacles for you. Whatever work you perform for the sake of your land and for all the tasks up to the attainment of buddhahood itself may be done in my house, and may all those difficult tasks be remembered." Then one who had become the son of that city guardian spoke, saying: "When you were formerly the laywoman Huśa, I made the aspiration, 'May I become your son.' From that time forth, in every single lifetime you shall be my mother and I shall be your son. When you come to perform great work in the golden land through the power of your great aspiration, and when great harm arises in that land, may I in any case become your companion there in order to liberate all sentient beings from harm. And even when there is no king in that land, may I govern it according to the Dharma, and may I not be commandeered by others. Until I attain buddhahood, may I be your son and may you be my mother."

At that time, there was in that assembly a noblewoman who followed after the goddess Vimalaprabha. She was utterly swollen and drunk with pride, and her mind was deeply filled with attachment and desire. She made an aspiration, saying: "May I also become your younger sister, and may all the karmas of mine — whatever they were — by which in my youth I deceived and seduced many men out of lustful desire, be purified."

There was another man sitting before the buddha, the Blessed One, in that assembly, and he said to that noblewoman: "The secret vow you have made on my behalf — that is something I will not release." At that time that man made an aspiration: "When in the future this noblewoman comes to dwell in Liyul together with the goddess Vimalaprabha and performs great deeds, may I depart from this existence and attain emergence from saṃsāra."

At that time the brother of the goddess Vimalaprabha, the bodhisattva Vajrasena, knelt before the Blessed One with one knee on the ground, joined his palms together, and said these words: "Venerable Blessed One, I shall become a Dharma-endowed king of the golden lineage, and in order to bring benefit to the land I shall become the companion of the goddess Vimalaprabha."

In order to restore the land of Liyul, I shall seek out all the wealth that lies buried beneath the earth in the golden land where the laywoman Husha dwells, and all that is found in the charnel grounds of the dead, and all that has become the property of the laywoman Husha, and I shall give abundantly of gold and many other riches. And this very wealth, O goddess Vimalaprabha, I shall offer before the Blessed Buddha for the sake of Liyul. When harm comes upon that land, no god, nāga, yakṣa, or spirit whatsoever shall obstruct that wealth. All the protectors of that land shall themselves become helpers, so that that wealth may by every means be found.

In the former golden mountain, in the place where the laywoman Husha came to dwell, another woman also appeared. She gave many gifts but did not guard her ethical conduct. And she made this aspiration: "By whatever merit I have accumulated through the gifts I have given, may I become the noble queen of a king of the golden lineage, and may I become a companion to one who likewise gives wealth for the restoration of that very land of Liyul."

At that time the young bodhisattva Vajrasena, the brother of the goddess Vimalaprabha, spoke these words: "When those great armies clash with one another, may I become a king of meteoric iron, so that when the Red-faces lead their armies into battle, wealth may be taken from the king of the golden lineage and given in accordance with the Dharma for the restoration of Liyul."

At that time another woman of noble birth, who had become a companion to the goddess, and who had attained the first ground, was present in that assembly. She made this aspiration: "May I become a noble queen in Liyul for seven successive lifetimes. When the time comes for those great armies to do battle in Liyul, may I take rebirth in the land of China. And when the young Vajrasena becomes the king of Li, may I become his noble queen, and may the two of us together restore Liyul, and may we also rebuild anew the pleasure groves of the Saṅgha, the monastery residences, the great stūpas, the bathhouses, and all that the Red-faces shall have burned."

When they had thus made these aspirations within the assembly, the Blessed One entered into meditative absorption called Vajradhvaja, the Banner of the Vajra. The Great King Vaiśravaṇa, the yakṣa Sarvajaya, the nāga king Anavatapta, the divine son Supraṭiṣṭhitamati, the goddess Harītī together with her children, and the goddess Vimalaprabha all likewise entered at that time into the meditative absorption called Buddhānusmṛti, Recollection of the Buddha.

Then, rising from meditative absorption, they knelt before the Blessed One with one knee on the ground and spoke these words: "Blessed One, we entreat you to commission us to guard that land of Liyul in the future, and we seek whatever service the Blessed One may command." Then all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (Skt. gandharva), asuras, garuḍas (Skt. garuḍa), kinnaras (Skt. kinnara), and

mahoragas (Skt. mahoraga), and all those human and non-human beings together caused a rain of flowers to fall in the sky above the Blessed One, and proclaimed in every kind of musical sound the offerings fit to be made to the Blessed One, the Buddha.

At that time, among that retinue, the Blessed One addressed in these words those into whose hands the guarding of that land had been entrusted — Vaiśravaṇa's son and Sarvajaya and the others: "Again and again I entrust the guarding of that land into your hands. When the Red-Faces seize the land and destroy and burn the Saṅgha's assembly halls, the perfume houses, and the great stūpas, and when they lay down perverse aspirations in order to demolish my teaching by every means — then, before long, those two armies will turn to fight one another. At that time the goddess Vimalaprabha's nephew, the young Vajrasena himself, shall go to the land of the Golden Clan and say this to the king of the Golden Clan: 'There exists the sūtra requested by Vimalaprabha, taught by the Blessed One Śākyamuni. This account of what came from Liyul was spoken by the Blessed One, the Buddha, and by the gods, and the word of the Blessed One, the buddhas, and the gods is not to be transgressed. The time has now come when the Red-Faces will seize the territory of Liyul, and they intend to advance into the land of the Golden Clan. When the two armies do battle with one another, it will be a great terror. When the Red-Faces become frightened, they will set out to go to the land of the Golden Clan.'

"The instruction of the Blessed One on this matter is as follows. When the land of the Golden Clan does not release the Red-Faces and the harm cannot come near from afar, at that time bring this sūtra as a written message to the land of the Golden Clan and say to the king of the Golden Clan: 'This was declared by the Blessed One, the Buddha, and by the gods. Gods and humans alike ought not to act against it. I shall give ransom for Liyul and, for the matter of the meteoric iron, give me much wealth.' When the wealth is obtained, first send wealth to Liyul, dispatch it to the Red-Faces, and give it also there to the people of Liyul. When goods are dispatched to Liyul, send the meteoric iron

there first as well, and act in accordance with human custom. At that time say this: 'I will not be a servant of the Red-Faces. Seize Liyul for me; give me the wealth; and their great military force will not be able to come there.' If their army does come to Liyul, say: 'Do not come there — I will give the price of whatever that land is worth.' If, for the purpose of ransoming the land, they act in accordance with this written message, then the whole of Liyul shall be gathered together and reconciled, and they will not be able to deceive it. Have no doubt in this."

When the Blessed One, the Buddha, had given this instruction to the goddess Vimalaprabha and to the bodhisattva Vajrasena, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, who emit rays of light and send forth bodhisattvas — those ones — together with the gods and the rest of the retinue assembled there, all spoke these words: "We too, at whatever time harm may come to befall that land, will give to the goddess Vimalaprabha a dhāraṇī mantra that she will be able to recall, and a dhāraṇī mantra such that, when it is held in mind, she will come to understand all the other great dhāraṇī mantras."

Thereupon she attained the meditative absorption called Buddhacetanā, Recollection of the Buddha's Mind,

Abiding in that absorption, she would behold all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, dwelling in all buddha-fields, and would hear them teach the Dharma; and the gods, too, would bestow what is excellent.

Thereupon all those buddhas, the Blessed Ones, who had previously sent forth rays of light, said "Excellent!" to the goddess Vimalaprabha and spoke these words:

For the sake of your complete protection,
whatever has been entrusted regarding the land of Li —
as the supreme Victor has declared,
so do likewise with great wisdom.

Secret mantras, too, unmatched by any other on earth,
shall be given.

At whatever time harm may come to befall that land of Li,
at that time we shall take thought,
and wisdoms of that very kind shall also be given.

At that time Brahmā and the other gods, and the thirty-two lords of power on earth, speaking in unison, declared: "A dhāraṇī mantra by which nāgas, yakṣas, spirits, asuras, non-humans, and humans alike shall cause no harm —

that mantra we shall give."

tadyathā: indra-datta triśula-haśa sarva-pāśa-bandhane nicindāne dra dra dra
dra ja ja ja ja budtīra nicinna-de tāla-hili aśva-sthāne na-nine-ni pu pu pu pu
indra-yugina viśa viśa viśa viśa svāhā.

This is the dhāraṇī mantra called Stability of the Horse. By this dhāraṇī mantra the rakṣasas (Skt. rākṣasa) of the Delighter class were overcome, and by means of the accomplishment of existence the discordant sounds, too, were overcome.

Thereupon Brahmā and all the other gods, and that entire retinue, spoke these words: "This mantra of knowledge may be tied to the tip of a victory banner, or tied to the head of a horse, or tied around one's own neck — in whatever place one goes into battle, one will be unconquerable by others and will be victorious in all circumstances. It is to be kept in purity as befits a divine object."

The king, lord of the land of Li, shall have a great assembly depicted in a painting on cloth. He shall have the royal palace purified and adorned throughout with canopies, victory banners, and pennants, and shall have it fumigated with vessels filled with various incenses. Various flowers shall be strewn, and it shall be beautified with garlands of various flowers. Those who serve there shall, just as they would abstain in the presence of the king together with his queen and retinue, likewise abstain, and with pure garments and pure food and drink shall be maintained. With the depicted image of the great assembly seated on the royal throne, and before it the ground well anointed with cow-dung wash, a maṇḍala shall be made. The practitioner himself shall also be well bathed and clothed in clean garments, and shall have those attendants do likewise.

On the day when the purification of the ritual ground is performed, first the entire royal palace shall be sprinkled with the five products of a cow. Alternatively, it shall be sprinkled with water in which all incenses have been infused. Then a maṇḍala of sixteen cubits shall be made perfectly square. Within it shall be placed three hundred food offerings, three hundred and sixty butter lamps anointed with grain-oil and fragrant oil, one thousand two hundred and thirty canopies, one thousand two hundred and thirty pennants, thirty-two vases, four great vases, and four conch shells. This dhāraṇī mantra, too, shall be placed at the center of that maṇḍala. Many cymbals shall be sounded and many musical sounds proclaimed.

The practitioner shall then recite praises to Brahmā and all the other gods, and shall also recite this dhāraṇī mantra. The practitioner shall, for the full month of accomplishment, establish the knowledge of the varied praises of all the gods.

This rite shall be performed for seven days, concluded with a fast, and on the seventh day a ritual bath shall be taken. This rite shall be performed on the fifth day of the month, just as was described before. The practitioner himself shall sit in the presence of the maṇḍala. There shall be two fire hearths: one is for the practitioner's own benefit, and one is for the month of accomplishment. In them, fire offerings shall be made one hundred and eight times by means of the rite. The dhāraṇī mantra of Hayagrīva shall also be recited one hundred and eight times. Fire offerings of dūrvā grass shall likewise be made one hundred and eight times. Saffron water shall be sprinkled many times upon the maṇḍala until it takes on the color of gold. The butter for the fire offering shall be anointed with fine fragrance and the fire offering performed. The maṇḍala shall be beautifully smeared with a paste of cow dung. When the recitation is to begin, drums shall be beaten and musical sounds proclaimed, and offering shall be made to the Three Jewels. The rite shall be commenced and the secret mantra recited at the time of sunset on the first fifth day of the month. Alternatively, it may be commenced on the sixth or seventh day. At dawn, the god of fire shall first be invited, and dūrvā grass fire offerings shall be performed just as was taught before. The food offerings that have been set out shall be removed and fresh ones placed. For three or seven days following the completion of the fire offering, fresh food offerings shall be placed. Within the center of that maṇḍala, a buddha image, the sacred Dharma, and relics shall also be placed. In that maṇḍala shall be set ten canopies, ten victory banners, ten pennants, ten great drums, ten bells, three hundred and sixty garlands of flowers, and three hundred and sixty butter lamps.

After performing the rite in this way, one shall begin in that same maṇḍala on the eighth day of the month, and up through the fifteenth day shall commence the elaborate rite of the noble Avalokiteśvara, reciting the mantra. When one desires to undertake a great enterprise by means of these rites of the Hayagrīva dhāraṇī mantra, or desires to go into great battle, or desires to attain lordship and sovereignty over a great king, one shall recite this Hayagrīva dhāraṇī mantra according to the elaborate rite described here. At that time, the gods will bestow the consecration and the empowerment. When one is about to begin reciting with the elaborate rite of the noble

Avalokiteśvara, and performs it in that same maṇḍala according to the earlier tradition, at that time the Blessed One, a buddha, will first send forth rays of light, and from his mind — which is the source of whatever dhāraṇī mantras he has bestowed — the bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara himself, together with many gods, will come to that place and also bestow the consecration. And thus whatever is wished for will be accomplished.

As for the rites of this dhāraṇī mantra — these elaborate rites — when one is about to undertake a great enterprise, or when one sees an enemy and is going into battle, if one recites the mantra over armor, one will be protected. If one recites the mantra over a sword, or over a bow, or over arrows, and then with saffron recites the mantra one hundred and eight times over the maṇḍala and marks the foreheads of all soldiers and all horses with a circle, and anoints with that saffron the gates of cities, the royal palace, or the gates of the capital, one will be victorious everywhere and will be entirely freed from all fears.

Then again the gods bestowed another dhāraṇī mantra: *Namo brahmaṇe, nama sarva-devānāṃ, tadyathā, brahmaṇa, indri-devānāṃ, pratiṣṭhite, aśvasthāne, vara-inde-sattva-phasmava, hare, āma-bhakupa-gaga-kṛ-śrī-likara, sarva-deva-grāva-svāhā*. This is the dhāraṇī mantra for the maṇḍala, and one should recite it within that maṇḍala as one wishes. If one recites it seven times over saffron, it will accomplish all the rites previously described in the context of the horse-stable dhāraṇī mantra, and the ritual of offering for the sevenfold recitation is as described before. When one is going into battle, if one recites both this secret mantra and the horse-stable secret mantra seven times each, one should affix them, together with the rays of light and the dhāraṇī mantras described previously, to the tip of the general's victory banner, and one should also carry them on one's person.

When one begins the recitation of the horse-stable vidyā mantra, for seven days one should keep oneself pure, as though dwelling in the abode of the gods, and the abstentions are as follows. If one begins on the thirteenth day of the month, one should abstain from everything. If one begins on the fourteenth day, one should not eat meat. If one begins on the fifteenth day, one should eat cooked rice mixed with milk, or rice porridge, or cooked rice with butter, and should not drink water.

Then the Blessed One, the Buddha, bestowed this dhāraṇī mantra: Nama śrī-subhottama-prabhāsasya, tathāgatasya, tadyathā, buddha-dharme, asaṅga-prati, vase, bodhi bodhi, drave-śrī-sare sare, visarve duḥkha-śrī-lamkāra-sarva-durprabhāse-vara-kṛ-tiṣṭhiti-svāhā. Wherever the horse-stable vidyā mantra is being recited, this dhāraṇī mantra should also be recited there. For whatever spiritual attainment one desires, or for whatever other rite one performs, or even if one desires treasure, one should recite this dhāraṇī mantra thirty-three times.

Then the four guardians of the world and all the gods of the retinue of the Four Great Kings pressed their palms together and spoke thus: We wish to proclaim this dhāraṇī mantra for the purpose of repelling whatever yakṣas and spirits there may be, to pacify all spirits, plagues, and diseases, and furthermore to recite it three times as a protection against whatever illness afflicts men or children. Or, if three knots are tied and fastened on, diseases caused by spirits will be pacified. One whose child, once born, does not survive should perform the rite oneself, and should also recite it as a protection for the children.

Then the Four Great Kings addressed the Blessed One, saying: May the Blessed One also grant his confirmation. Thereupon the Blessed One, the Buddha, proclaimed this dhāraṇī mantra through Vajradhvaja: Tadyathā, badkudri, vajralaphu-svāhā. This dhāraṇī mantra was proclaimed by the Blessed One Śākyamuni and by Vajradhvaja, together with the gods of the retinue of the Four Great Kings and the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, for the purpose of its accomplishment: for one from whose nose blood flows, for one on whose body a wound has arisen, or arising from another underlying condition, for women from whose bodies blood drips and flows — one should recite the mantra over a red thread and place it on the crown of the head, and one should also apply it to the wound. If there is a plague, or a disease caused by spirits, or swelling, one should recite the mantra over a thread, tie ten knots in it, and fasten it around the neck. For one who has dysentery, or

for one who has dysentery arising from a bilious condition, one should recite the mantra over a yellow thread, tie ten knots in it, and fasten it around the waist.

At that time the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara proclaimed this dhāraṇī mantra: Namo ratnatrayāya. Namo āryāvalokiteśvarāya bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya. Tadyathā: sare sare visare visare viśanaśaniye svāhā.

This pacifies completely all diseases sent by spirits and all epidemic diseases. When a sick person has come to the point of death, and their color has faded and half their life-force has been seized away, one should recite this dhāraṇī mantra:

Tadyathā: bodha bodha, āryāvalokiteśvara, raśmiprabhasebhuta, jambhe phu phu phu, karule phu svāhā.

To pacify all epidemic diseases and all spirit-possession by means of this dhāraṇī mantra, one should recite it three times and tie three knots in a thread and fasten it on. The recitation is to be performed after eating a meal.

This dhāraṇī was proclaimed by all the buddhas and by Avalokiteśvara:

Namo astikārājakaribuddhasya tathāgatasya. Tadyathā: āṅgare maṅgare phu vacagare phu vajra phu buddharāje phu hyarete phu dripare phu svāhā.

This is the secret mantra for poison. If someone has drunk poison, or if a cataract has formed in the eye, or for a festering wound — whether over food, or water, or medicine, or the ground — if one recites it seven times, all will be pacified.

At that time the gods of the hosts of the Four Great Kings proclaimed dhāraṇī mantras, and said: In accordance with the qualities that were spoken of above, designated by those very names, we now bestow these dhāraṇī mantras:

Tadyathā: śānatamukhī vimukhī vimale vimukhe ḍaḍhakhamula svāhā.

This dhāraṇī pacifies all epidemic diseases caused by spirits, the epidemics of the four diseases, and contagious illness. This dhāraṇī mantra must not be opposed or violated by any spirits. When one recites the vidyā mantra of the Stable Abode, first one should fasten a thread with these secret mantras. When entering the interior of the maṇḍala as well, one should place these boundary-protections there, recite each dhāraṇī mantra three times, tie three knots in the thread, and fumigate with all incenses before the presence of the buddhas. In front of the maṇḍala one should place a painted image of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara and burn incense of dūruka or black aloe wood. For the gods, one should burn incense of turpentine resin and bdellium. Then one should make this aspiration:

Just as the blessed buddhas commanded me to protect the districts and their surroundings, and just as the gods pledged to become my helpers — in accordance with what the buddhas have commanded and what the gods have pledged, may this work of mine be accomplished in just that way and brought

to its completion.

At that time all the blessed buddhas and the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi proclaimed the names of the Tathāgatas:

Homage to the Tathāgata Excellent Gold.

Homage to the Tathāgata All-Seeing.

Homage to the Tathāgata Luminous and Immaculate.

Homage to the Tathāgata in Whom All Intentions Are Perfectly Complete.

Homage to the Tathāgata known as the Great Sage Who Is Utterly Fearsome Yet Free from Timidity.

Tadyathā: karavara irivara, sasura mamara, bavara, buddha adhiṣṭhite —

dharma adhiṣṭhite, saṅgha adhiṣṭhite, brahma adhiṣṭhite, śakra adhiṣṭhite, vajrapāṇi guhyaka adhiṣṭhite, vidyā adhiṣṭhite, sarva deva adhiṣṭhite svāhā.

This dhāraṇī mantra is spoken in the Sūtra of Vajrapāṇi's Great Secret Gnosis, and it pacifies all illness and all fear completely.

Homage to the Tathāgata Who Cuts Through All Harm.

Homage to the Tathāgata Śākyamuni.

Tadyathā: vajrakara, daramara, sarva tarya, aṣaṣa, vivisukhakārā svāhā.

This dhāraṇī mantra was spoken by the Blessed One, the Buddha, for the purpose of conferring empowerment.

Syādyetadan: deva cara padamāra, maṇḍala samāse devānānā, buddha devānānā, puṇyākara, sarva parśa karya, prajñānānā, āhara mi kara siddha na svāhā.

For the purpose of conferring empowerment, the entire retinue spoke thus.

Tadyathā: tsad cara cara cara, kara huru ra, kṣe hora ra, da da da da, karakṣa svāhā.

Just as Māra's armies were unable to move the Blessed One, the Buddha, from the seat of awakening at Vajrāsana, so too, through this secret mantra, no one is able to move or turn back from what the youthful Vajra-host himself has pledged.

Then from within that assembly, all the goddesses and women who were present and who had been struck by curses spoke thus to the goddess Immaculate Light: "You have received from the Blessed One the dhāraṇī mantra by which one is liberated from birth as a woman. Please give it to us,

that we may receive this dhāraṇī mantra from you."

At that time the goddess Immaculate Light requested the dhāraṇī mantra from the Blessed One, the Buddha, and then bestowed it upon them.

Tadyathā: jaloka man tapa, sarva bhuya srakara svāhā.

Whoever recites this dhāraṇī mantra will be liberated from birth as a woman.

Tadyathā: sarva bhudhanān, sarva dega mara, gan pa śara ra svāhā.

All the buddhas and all the gods proclaimed this dhāraṇī mantra, and nothing is able to create obstacles to it.

At that time the goddess Immaculate Light addressed the Blessed Buddhas and the gods thus: "Please grant me the dhāraṇī mantra by which wisdom is attained, by which one will be able to carry out in the future precisely what the Blessed Buddhas have commanded, by which no one will be able to create obstacles for us, by which even those who make aspirational prayers to obstruct me will not be able to harm me, by which I will gradually perform the enlightened activity of a buddha, and by which I will be able to perfectly fulfill the Dharma-aspiration of all sentient beings."

At that time the Blessed Buddhas and the gods spoke thus: "We will assist you so that no one is able to disturb your mind."

Homage to the Tathāgata Sovereign of Manifest Dharma.

Homage to the Buddha.

Homage to the Dharma.

Homage to the Saṅgha.

Homage to the Tathāgata Śākyamuni.

Tadyathā: abhiṣekyā, vidda bhi, arabiry a javara, kuma sa sarva ava aprīya da svāhā.

This dhāraṇī mantra was spoken by all the buddhas for the sake of Immaculate Light.

Tadyathā: brahma śakra ca sa vahi, pura mruga gamana, kusama na janā dānu, parama jina na jvara jarani, jina piva na kara, karṭhā dara svāhā.

This dhāraṇī mantra was spoken by the Blessed Buddhas so that, by its light, Immaculate Light would in no way be able to perform sinful actions. If seven knots are tied in a cord and it is fastened around one's neck, no one will be able to create obstacles or bring defeat.

Tadyathā: ha de bhī hā te, ya ku na ma svāhā.

This was taught by the noble Avalokiteśvara in order to purify the sins of the goddess Immaculate Light. For her protection, seven knots should be tied in a cord, it should be fastened around her neck, and it should be recited after eating.

At that time the goddess Immaculate Light spoke thus: "Please also grant me the dhāraṇī by which eye ailments are pacified.

Homage to the Tathāgata Purifier of the Eye.

Homage to the Tathāgata who dispels the darkness of eye-cataracts.

Homage to the Tathāgata who abides in the eye of the Dharma.

Tadyathā: ta ta cakṣu ra ma la ba, ma bhi sa ra ma ma cakṣuḥ środ tra, pra bha kas kar svāhā.

This dhāraṇī mantra should be recited one hundred and eight times before the Blessed Buddhas, and each day it should be recited seven times over water and used to wash the eyes. It should be recited five times over eye medicine and then applied.

Namo vajra dharasya tathāgatasya. Tadyathā: iṇṭi ni biṭi ni, ni ga ra a ga re, ba kha re phu, ka kha khā re phu svāhā.

This dhāraṇī mantra is to be used for dispelling all fears and for protecting a city.

The Blessed Buddha then spoke thus to the goddess Immaculate Light and to the bodhisattva Vajrasena. At that time, a prince of King Ajātaśatru named young Vajrasena was present in that assembly — a prince whose thumb had been cut off at the order of his elder brother, the son of King Ajātaśatru, so that his own son might by all means obtain sovereignty over the kingdom. That prince made this aspiration: "When young Vajrasena comes to hold sovereignty over the realm of the meteor-stone, may I then have become king of the land of Li and, in order to hold both sides in battle, become his ally, so that from that time forward we will never be enemies to one another."

At that time Kauṇḍinya the brahmin had a student who was a brahmin's son. He gave that student over to a different teacher, one who had no faith in the Buddha, so that brahmin student was not one who had gone forth. That student, who was present in the assembly, saw the Blessed Buddha enter into the meditative absorption (samādhi) of courageous conduct. He then made this aspiration: "May I train exclusively in the definitive practice of the

meditative absorption of courageous conduct, attain realization of it, and thereby impart to the goddess Immaculate Light the dhāraṇī mantra of Stable Horse so that she may accomplish it."

By this dhāraṇī through which the Blessed Buddhas are victorious over the armies of māra, young Vajrasena will complete all the activities of kingship in accordance with the Dharma.

Homage to the Tathāgata Śākyamuni.

Homage to the Tathāgata Supreme of All Clans, Universally Glorious.

Tadyathā: sarva karṇi, sarva ma ra ha raṇe, ja li ja ca li, ma ra ba ra sa pa ba ra svāhā.

This dhāraṇī mantra that māra cannot overcome should be recited seven times after eating. Just as the Blessed Buddhas defeated māra, so young Vajrasena will be victorious and will conquer the borderlands as well. By the vidyā mantra of Stable Horse, all activities will be accomplished accordingly.

Saffron is enchanted with mantra, a dot is marked on it or seven knots are tied in a cord, and it is placed upon a maṇḍala. When one goes into battle, it is bound and worn upon the body, and victory will be obtained. The earlier dhāraṇī mantras should be recited just as before.

When the Blessed Buddhas proclaimed the dhāraṇī mantra called Stable Horse, the Blessed One declared this to all the gods and to the entire assembly gathered there: "Gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, great serpents, humans and non-humans — all of you who are assembled here: just as I gave the dhāraṇī mantra called Stable Horse to the goddess Stainless Light and to young Vajrasena, so too shall I give the secret mantra to you. By it all enemies shall be reconciled; by it oneself shall become supremely blessed and fully resplendent with majesty; those dwelling in palaces and within homes shall come to wellbeing; and those engaged in fighting and warfare shall be brought to an end. This dhāraṇī mantra I give to the goddess Stainless Light, to young Vajrasena, and to your four retainers for the sake of the land of Khotan, so that by this dhāraṇī mantra you shall without fail be endowed with blessing and resplendent with majesty. Likewise, let young Vajrasena be freed from all harm."

Then at that moment the thirty-two lords of the earth, the four guardians of the world, the lord of the yakṣas Sarvavijaya, the nāga king Anavatapta, Hārītī together with her retinue, and all the protectors of the land of Khotan rose

from their seats and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, we wish to take the land of Khotan under our care. At the time when Stainless Light and Vajrasena take rebirth there, and at the time when the Blessed Buddhas send forth rays of light upon those two and bestow consecration upon them, we shall come there and wish to be granted consecration as well. Blessed One, please explain the dhāraṇī mantra to us. We wish to receive it."

Thereupon the Blessed Buddha Śākyamuni, and those Blessed Buddhas who were sending forth rays of light, and those Tathāgatas who were giving forth utterances of speech, proclaimed this dhāraṇī mantra:

Homage to the Tathāgata dwelling in the royal sovereignty of renunciation.

Homage to the Tathāgata, supremely exalted, dwelling in the royal sovereignty of buddhahood.

Homage to the Tathāgata dwelling in the royal sovereignty of the lion's Dharma.

Homage to the Tathāgata dwelling in the royal sovereignty of the equal blossoming of the limbs of awakening.

Homage to the Tathāgata King of Illuminating Light.

Homage to the Tathāgata King of Compassionate Illuminating Light.

Homage to the Tathāgata King of the Light of Illuminating Radiance.

Homage to the Tathāgata King of the Light Adorned with the Glory of the Praises of the Qualities of Illuminating Radiance.

Tadyathā: vara indre, vara apara, indre ranu mabhe, ākāśa kabake, indre, staskra vakaraṭa, badakra vabhe, śapasura, prate, tatha thanduru idra du svāhā.

This dhāraṇī is called Illuminating Radiance. By this dhāraṇī mantra one shall become dear to the hearts of all humans and non-humans alike, and shall be endowed with majesty.

The speech of sentient beings will become agreeable, and commands given to them will not be refused.

Butter, too, shall be cooked with this preparation: with the hard resin of the srā tree, the three kinds of sandalwood, jamāka, the scale of elephant skin, the insect sughaṅga, karkoṭa, juniper, black cardamom, pippalī, the rā tree, āvayak, the crystal plant, and the white-flowered snāma — whatever is the total measure of all the other medicinal substances combined, an equal measure of the white-flowered snāma shall be added — and all these shall be

cooked together in butter and water. Then this dhāraṇī mantra and the vidyā mantra of the maṇḍala set forth earlier, known as the Horse Station, shall be applied to it. Done in this way it is properly accomplished. When the brew has been prepared, one recites the mantra thirty-three times and drinks it, whereupon one will be freed from all fears of disease. At that time one should recite praises to the gods.

This butter called Illuminating Radiance, and this dhāraṇī called Illuminating Radiance, brings joy to gods and humans alike. Whenever this dhāraṇī is recited, the pleasure groves of the gods become supremely beautiful; their minds become glad and filled with delight. At that moment those gods remember the word of the Buddha, and they proceed to where the goddess Immaculate Light resides. There they say to her: "Whenever you recite the dhāraṇī of Illuminating Radiance, our pleasure groves become supremely beautiful, extraordinarily blooming with abundance. Just as we once petitioned the Blessed One on behalf of the youth Vajrasena, so too we now grant you every excellent thing you desire."

When the youth Vajrasena and the goddess Immaculate Light heard those words of the Blessed One and of the gods, they touched both knees to the ground, joined their palms together, and spoke thus: "The command that the Blessed One has given us in this regard is exceedingly great. If only the Blessed One and the gods would be our helpers, we would take the land of the country of Liyul under our protection."

Then Immaculate Light said: "When the time comes to protect that land, may the buddha, the Blessed One himself, send rays of light upon me. And may I also attain that patience by which my dhāraṇī will be fully understood."

Thereupon the buddha, the Blessed One Śākyamuni, and the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, who had previously sent forth rays of light and who had spoken words from within those rays of light, all declared: "Excellent, Immaculate Light! Excellent! When your time comes, there will be a moment when you are thus filled with grief and sorrow. When your former companions in virtue and in wrongdoing set out to do battle, your elder brother Vajrasena will appear and will take part in that battle. At that time, overcome with grief and sorrow, you will think to yourself: 'It would be easy enough for me to die.' Then, remaining alone in one place, you will recite the dhāraṇī of the Tathāgata Amitābha called Nectar of Melodious Drums, and you will petition the Blessed One in these words, turning over three wishes in your mind, saying: 'Until at

least one of these three is accomplished I shall not leave my chamber of sorrow — either may I meet my elder brother; or may I die; or may I bring saṃsāra to its end."

At that time the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, spoke thus: "In that chamber of sorrow of yours, you will attain the patience by which the dhāraṇī mantras will be understood. At that time those buddhas, the Blessed Ones, will send forth rays of light upon you, and you will hear the sound of divine music, the sound of the divine retinue, and the sound of divine drums. Then the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, together with the gods, will bestow upon you the words 'Excellent!' You will also understand the dhāraṇī mantra of the wheel of non-regression, and thereafter you will also obtain those dhāraṇīs through which you will bring benefit to sentient beings."

The Inquiry of Vimalaprabha, the Third Chapter.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, then spoke to the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara: "Dear brother, call this time to mind. When the Blessed One, the Buddha Ratnagarbha, entered the city, the two of us assembled there upon hearing the prophecy, and you made this great aspiration: 'May I deliver from fear and terror all those sentient beings, however many there may be who are afraid and frightened.' Then you entrusted to my care your realm of Li, the goddess Vimalaprabha, and the youth Vajrasena.

"Thereupon the Blessed One spoke to the bodhisattvas Samantabhadra, Mañjuśrī the youthful, Ākāśagarbha, Mahābalavāpta, the King of Medicine, Pradānasūra, Kṣitigarbha, and the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, saying: 'Those who were formerly friends and brothers, and those who will become our companions — the lord of the lordly devas, the sovereign king of trees, the lord of compassion Thāskar, the lord of cutting, the lord of fragrance, the lord of assemblies, the lord of the world, the lord of light, the lord of birth, and the god of all — these are the companions of the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara.' Then the Blessed One, the Buddha, entrusted to the hands of all those bodhisattvas, just as one entrusts the guarding of the realm of Li, the youth Vajrasena and the goddess Vimalaprabha.

"Thereupon the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī spoke thus: 'I have been a companion to all past Blessed Ones, the buddhas, and to those who will come in the future, for the purpose of their attaining the awakening of buddhahood; I have heard their Dharma too. I also wish to be entrusted with the full protection of the realm of Li. Taking rebirth there, I shall distribute the relics. Moreover, I shall

bestow upon this goddess a dhāraṇī mantra through which she will come to remember her past lives, and through which she will remember all those teachings she has heard from the Blessed Ones, the buddhas.'

"Homage to the Tathāgata Luminosity. Homage to the bodhisattva who acts as a great elephant. Homage to Mañjuśrī the youthful.

Tadyathā: buṣadhare bhāṣadatse vajraśmi svāhā.

If this is recited three times by day and three times by night, one will come to remember past lives, and will remember all the teachings previously heard.

"Then the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī further recited this dhāraṇī mantra:

Tadyathā: pratyudnarune pratyudsarākaṇarīkṣaṇi svāhā.

When one who practises yoga is seated in one place and recites this, conceptual thoughts will be purified and the aspects of virtue will increase."

At whatever time one performs actions with the vidyā mantra of stable abiding, it should be recited three more times. Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra spoke thus: "At whatever time this goddess first comes to comprehend the dhāraṇī mantra, I will lend her assistance, so that she may truly comprehend it exactly as it is. And in order that she may come to comprehend it through obtaining the dhāraṇī mantra called Coiled Conch from the synonyms of the Dharma of the White Lotus of the Sacred Dharma (Skt. Saddharmapuṇḍarīka), which carries out the actions of all sentient beings — and so that having comprehended the dhāraṇī mantra, she may bestow it upon all sentient beings; and so that the youthful Vajrasena may be made to recollect the word of the Buddha; and so that through these dhāraṇī mantras the Dharma may be recollected — all those words of the Buddha that the blessed buddhas are presently uttering shall be remembered; and I have ensured that attachment therein will be exhausted."

Then the blessed Buddha called out to the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara and declared these words: "Dear younger brother, remember this time — when the Blessed One Jewel Heart was proceeding to the city, at the gate of that city there sat a blind woman, severely afflicted by leprosy, and with her sat a small boy who served as the eyes for the blind one. Now, when the Blessed One Jewel Heart was setting out to go to the city, sentient beings were running swiftly back and forth in order to make offerings to the Blessed One, and the woman was seized with great fear and dread, thinking: 'Has a great army come to this city? Or has something arrived — many wild beasts, elephants,

lions, tigers, and the like, rushing about in great numbers?' At that moment she cried out: 'Is there anyone of compassionate nature? Let someone speak to me, for I am utterly terrified — has an army come to slay me, or have predators come to tear me apart?' At that very time, Avalokiteśvara, you had taken the form of an aged brahmin, and you said to that sick woman: 'Do not be afraid. There is no danger of an army in this city, no danger from many wild beasts, nor anything else at all — it is many people running back and forth in order to make offerings to the Blessed One, precious Jewel Heart, who is coming to the city.' Then the woman said to the small boy: 'Take my hand, child, go ahead and lead me to where the Blessed One abides.' And that child, by the power of the rays of the Buddha's light, went together with his mother to that city gate.

When the Blessed One entered the city, all the sentient beings present who were sick, blind, lame, deaf, hunchbacked, insane, and so forth were entirely healed. At the very place where the great brahmin called Ocean-Dust had made aspiration prayers, and where many bodhisattvas had received the prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, that woman too was healed. There she had made an aspiration to attain buddhahood, praying: 'At whatever time this brahmin Ocean-Dust attains full awakening, may I at that time abide in his teaching — and just as the brahmin who took me up from the aggregate of births and led me for the sake of the Buddha's teaching has himself received the prophecy as foretold, may I too thereby receive the prophecy of attaining buddhahood.' Then the brahmin who was skillfully revealing the Buddha to that woman —

saying, 'May I become a refuge for all sentient beings who are afraid and terrified' — at that very moment the woman also spoke thus: 'When you have become the refuge of all those sentient beings who are afraid and terrified, remember me then, for I too shall be your helper.' Having spoken these words, the woman then made an aspiration to attain buddhahood right there.

Now, when the goddess Vimalaprabha heard the account of past lives from the Blessed One, the buddha, she made a great aspiration and spoke thus: 'All those bodhisattvas have become buddhas, while I am still appearing in a woman's form — I am deeply ashamed of this. Yet the great karmic destiny declared by the Blessed One cannot be otherwise. If I do not take birth as a woman, how could I carry out those very deeds declared by the Blessed One? Therefore, just as other women who are possessed of attachment, aversion, and delusion, so too shall I appear here in the form of a woman. And when the

time arrives for me to recall all my buddha-activities and my aspirations, may I take birth together with this youth in the land of Li, and may things come to pass exactly as the Blessed One has declared. When harm befalls the land of Li, may we become the deliverers there. Then, coming to this world-realm of Endurance from every direction — wherever I may go, taking birth as a woman among gods and humans — in all those lives may I remember my past existences. After the Blessed One has uttered this declaration and I have died, may I be born in the world-realm Sukhāvatī, where even the name of woman does not exist. And from there, without long delay, may I return here and utterly liberate all suffering sentient beings belonging to the five destinies. When Maitreya (the future buddha Loving-Kindness) arrives here, may I go forth in order to contemplate the bodhisattva's sky-like words (his teaching, as vast as the sky) in their proper measure. In all my lives, however many sentient beings shall have accumulated merit together with me, or shall do so, or shall have seen me, or shall merely have heard my name — may I utterly liberate every one of them.'

Such was the aspiration she made.

When the goddess Vimalaprabha had spoken these words, the Blessed One declared the following: 'The one who in times long past was the brahmin called Ocean-Dust — that is I, the Blessed One Śākyamuni. The old brahmin who skillfully revealed the Blessed One, the buddha, to that woman — that is the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the Sovereign of Compassion. The woman who fell ill — that is the goddess Vimalaprabha, daughter of King Ajātaśatru. The child who was her son at that time — that is the youth Vajrasena here. Now those who were to come afterward must also be identified. Among the stars and those of the golden lineage, the first to arise from the laywoman Huśa, giving rise to the human lineage, was the laywoman Huśa herself, who came to dwell in that land of the golden lineage. That laywoman Huśa was of the divine lineage. Among the gods, a certain goddess fell into wrongdoing and was expelled from their company and cast down onto the golden mountain, and a curse was also laid upon her: "May you become a man-eating demoness there!"'

Then she showed the way to the many merchants who had come to that mountain of the golden lineage in search of gold, and that demoness enjoyed sensual pleasures together with those merchants. But when, at another time, other travellers arrived there, she ate those with whom she had previously enjoyed sensual pleasures. That demoness who had been cast down by the

gods' curse also made companions of five hundred other demonesses with whom travellers would arrive and with whom sensual pleasures were experienced. Now there was a bodhisattva named Ogpakchen who had become the caravan leader at that time. When the time came for the gods to purify her of her wrongdoing, she gave birth to a daughter who was given the name Huśa. This Huśa was one who had previously dwelt in the buddha-field of the Tathāgata whose name is Flower-Fully-Bloomed, Superknowledge, King of Stars, Petal of the Lotus, Free from Stain, and from that realm she had said: "This demoness, formerly born among the gods, has been my mother for many lifetimes. Now the bodhisattva Ogpakchen intends to eat her. I shall become her daughter and thus prevent her from committing that evil act." So she repeated this with a voice of compassion. At that time other travellers arrived there. Then Ogpakchen, after cutting off all the gates with his retinue, prepared to eat them, and gathered together with the newly arrived travellers. Then the small girl called Huśa, who had come to dwell among the demonesses, said to her father Ogpakchen: "Father, my lord, let us flee and escape from here before these demonesses eat us." At that time Ogpakchen was saved by his own daughter. Ogpakchen also saved all five hundred travellers, and together they all fled. Then the demoness went there and, not finding Ogpakchen, abandoned the newly arrived travellers there and ran in pursuit of Ogpakchen and the other travellers in order to find them. Previously, when she had dwelt in the world of the gods, she had gone outside, and for that reason had been punished: the gods had cut off her ears and left her on the mountain of the golden lineage, and the gods had laid a curse upon her, saying: "Whoever asks you, 'Who cut off your ears?', you shall be freed from the curse by that person, and you shall return to the world of the gods and become a goddess again as before." Then the time came for her to return to the world of the gods. While she was running in pursuit of the many travellers, she let down the long robe she was wearing, and put on the garment that had previously been made from the fur of a mountain deer, and bound her hair at the crown of her head. When the merchants who had fled came along behind her, she caught the caravan leader Ogpakchen and those five hundred merchants, stuffed them into her robe, and loaded them onto her shoulders. Then Ogpakchen laughed, and the demoness asked: "Son of man, why do you laugh? If you do not speak truthfully, I will pour your blood upon the ground." Then the caravan leader Ogpakchen said to her: "You who are so powerful — what being could have cut off your ears like this?" At that moment she released those travellers, stood in mid-air, and declared: "The name of this

country shall henceforth be called the Golden Lineage, on account of the ears." Having said this, her ears became just as they had been before, and she went to the world of the gods and became a goddess once more. The caravan leader Ogpakchen then returned together with those travellers to the mountain of the golden lineage, and there he raised and cared for that girl. All those demonesses became pregnant,

Among all of them, there was not a single one who, after experiencing the pleasures of desire together with her, did not kill that very being afterward. Then all those demonesses were filled with shame, and they raised those children, venerating Husha as they would a deity. Among all the sons they had borne, the one born first became the husband of Husha, and from that time forward the human lineage of the Golden Lineage came into being. Although Husha engaged in the pleasures of desire together with all the sons of those travelers, she was unable to satisfy them all. And so, because she had vowed to give sensual pleasure yet was unable to satisfy them all, through that karma she was reborn continuously as a woman. A son was born from Husha, and the laywoman Hushar came to be; the one who became her son became king there, and from that time forward the human lineage was established. The laywoman Hushar dwelt within a divine palace on the mountain of the Golden Lineage and taught the Dharma to gods, humans, and demonesses. At the time of Hushar's death, those five hundred demonesses, together with the gods and demons who had heard the Dharma from her, became the guardians of the land of the Golden Lineage, and so they remain to this day. The one who at that time became the laywoman Hushar is now Vimalaprabha, the Stainless Light. The one who became the first king of the land of Li, who proposed marriage and offered himself and his kingdom, is this Crystal King. The one who was to become king of Kashmir, who declared before the Blessed One, the buddha, "May I be reborn there," is the Crystal King Śakravarman, reborn as a disciple of Vimalaprabha. The one who, being the queen of the king of Kashmir, declared, "May I be reborn as his mother," will become the noble queen of King Śakravarman. The one who, being the elder brother of the goddess, made this aspiration — "May I become a beloved elder brother, and having obtained great renunciation through that grief, may I attain samādhi on impurity through that renunciation" — will become that elder brother. The one who, being the youngest sister, made this aspiration — "When I die of grief, may you go to the virtuous friend, the monk, and there attain liberation from saṃsāra" — will become that youngest sister. The youngest brother of

Vajrasena, who together with him made aspirations on account of the land of Li, will become an elder brother and will become the Crystal King. The one who governed the city of Ajātaśatru will become king of the Golden Lineage. The woman who gave generously but did not uphold ethical discipline will become the queen of that king.

Then at that time the Blessed One, the buddha, declared to the gods: "When the time comes for this goddess to be born first in the land of Li, the bodhisattva Maitreya (Skt. maitrī), dwelling in Tuṣita, together with the gods, will urge him — the god who was formerly Vajrasena, and the goddess who was formerly Vimalaprabha, and together with those with whom, having become a companion, she made aspirations — those gods will urge him,

to abandon their divine birth and take a human birth. The gods will urge in the same way both the one who governs the city of Ajātaśatru and the one who has become the son of that city's governor. They will urge those who have become father and mother, and those who made aspirations together with them, reminding them: the time has now come for what the Buddha declared and for the aspirations that were made — take birth in the land of Li.

Among these, the god known as the bodhisattva Vajrasena will become the king of the land of Li. The woman of noble birth who attained the grounds will become the queen of the land of Li for five successive lives. In six successive births she will take birth in the land of Li and become the consort of the bodhisattva king.

When the time arrives for the karma created in favor of the noble man's cause to ripen, all those who have entered his lineage will gather together. When that gathering first comes to the land of Li, this goddess will pass away from among the gods and be born as the daughter of the king of Meteor Stone. When the time comes for the Azha people and the gathering to arrive, the goddess Vimalaprabha will bring the one who had governed the city of Ajātaśatru and was her husband, lead him to the land of Gold, and they will come there together.

At that time, those military forces will arrive, and her father the king of Meteor Stone and two of her brothers will die in that battle. At that time Vimalaprabha, pierced with grief, will enter a chamber of sorrow, and without asking anyone else she will attain the meditative absorption of impurity on her own.

When the time arrives for the Red-Faces to make the land of Li into their vassal, the king known as Vijayakīrti will be slain in that battle. His son, a king known as Vijayayaśas, will arise. The king of Meteor Stone, known as Īśvaravarmā, together with his son, will die in battle alongside the king of Li. The present Vajrasena will become the son of Vijayavarmā and will become the king of Meteor Stone. He too will hold royal power for one year. Vijayayaśas will arise in the land of Li; Vijayavarmā will arise in Meteor Stone.

When the time arrives for the blessed buddhas to send forth rays of light to Vimalaprabha so that she will attain patience, at that time the party of the virtuous-doer and the party of the evil-doer will each divide into their own factions. At that time, the one who was formerly the father of both Śubhākara and Pāpakara — the one who set loose the five hundred bandits — will become king, and two great ministers will arise. The prince known as Vijayayaśas will become king of the land of Li; the one known as Vijayavarmā will become king of Meteor Stone.

Of those two youths, Śubhākara was raised by the chief great minister, and the other was raised by Pāpakara. When Śubhākara was born, five hundred merchants came and, having been born in the land of Li, performed virtuous deeds in that land. When Pāpakara was born, those five hundred bandits who had been set loose were born in the land of Li and committed evil deeds.

When the youth Pāpakara was born, those five hundred bandits were sent before the king's father. Then, at that time, having given orders to certain others, saying "Do you carry out whatever task there is," the chief of those great ministers had his hands cut off, and the other was killed. This too arose from the time when Pāpakara had formerly gouged out Śubhākara's eyes: those great ministers had come to be directly opposed to one another, and from that point forward, in every lifetime, each became the enemy of the other. Of those great ministers, the chief one will become king of Meteor Stone, and the other will become king of the land of Li. Those two will later wage war against each other.

Those who were on Pāpakara's side when the eyes of Śubhākara were gouged out will kill the king of Li. When the time comes for the Red-Faced Ones to seize the land of Li, those two will fight one another. At that time, the one now known as Vajrasena, who is the maternal nephew of the goddess Vimalaprabha, will become king of Meteor Stone under the name Vijayavarmā, and on account of that nephew he will be tormented by grief. When the time

comes for a buddha's ray of light to rest upon him, he will defeat the king of Meteor Stone. Yet if he lacks merit, those who make aspiration prayers to the Blessed One, the Buddha, saying "May the perfumery and the Saṅgha's pleasure grove be destroyed," will not become his allies.

When the Red-Faced Ones act as allies, seize the land of Li, and destroy the Saṅgha's pleasure grove and the perfumery, the king of Meteor Stone will be defeated. When, before long, the time comes for the Red-Faced Ones to arrive, Vimalaprabha will be overcome with the deepest grief. At that time the Blessed Buddhas and the guardian deities of the land of Li will offer their care. Then Vimalaprabha, sitting alone in a chamber of grief, will make supplication to the buddhas. Having also recited the dhāraṇī mantra called Nectar Drum, she will supplicate the Tathāgata Amitābha, saying: "May I either meet my nephew, or may I die, or may I pass beyond saṃsāra entirely."

Then, in the early morning hours, the Blessed Buddhas will send rays of light upon her, and she will also attain the dhāraṇī mantra and the patience. At that time the buddhas and the gods will pronounce "Excellent!" The sons of the gods will ring bells and sound great drums and music, saying: "A great deed has been performed by a non-regressing bodhisattva."

At that time, knowing within herself that she had repaid the kindness of her parents and that offerings would therefore be made to her, she will act for the first time. Formerly, when Śubhakarā caused a rain of jewels to fall from the wish-fulfilling jewel, the great minister made an aspiration prayer on behalf of Śubhakarā at that very first moment; and then certain others said: "If all the aspirations we have made do not turn away from any of this, we will serve as allies so that even the slightest part of the teaching is not later destroyed." The youth Vijayavarmā, who will become king of Meteor Stone, will also act as an ally. Those great ministers on Pāpakara's side who also made aspiration prayers on Śubhakarā's behalf will later turn back.

When the Blessed One had spoken those words, Avalokiteśvara addressed him thus: "I too shall encourage them at that time. I shall teach the Dharma to all of them, so that they all come to retain it and can in turn teach it to others — this I shall do. My sister as well has been practicing the conduct of awakening together with me."

Then all the gods rose and said: "We too wish to go there." At that moment, a rain of divine flowers fell upon the buddha, the Blessed One, and divine cymbals were sounded.

Then the buddha, the Blessed One, spoke these words: "Those buddhas, those Blessed Ones, sent forth rays of light upon him. From those rays of light, words arose that expressed the intended meaning just as it is, so that he would obtain the words of dhāraṇī-mantras; and so that, for the sake of the matter of the brother Vijayavarmā being defeated in battle, he would obtain dhāraṇī-mantras; and so that, by his obtaining those dhāraṇī-mantras, others too would obtain them; and so that he who sat dejected in a house of grief, in order to carry out the tasks the Blessed One had declared for the sake of the land of Li, would obtain dhāraṇī-mantras from those buddhas, those Blessed Ones."

Homage to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened one — the king of the unmoving mind who pacifies harm.

Homage to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened one — who possesses a mind of discernment and utterly pacifies the darkness of obscured vision.

Homage to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened one — the lord of the great elephant.

Homage to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened one — who cuts like a vajra.

Homage to the Tathāgata, the king of gods.

Homage to the Tathāgata, the king supremely exalted above all non-Buddhists.

Homage to the Tathāgata, the supreme one of meditative absorption.

Homage to the Tathāgata, the king of marks.

Homage to the Tathāgata, who illuminates with radiance.

Homage to the Tathāgata, the king of all non-Buddhists.

Homage to the Tathāgata, the king who bestows gifts.

Homage to the Tathāgata — queen sovereign of qualities, moving like a vajra.

Homage to the Tathāgata, who enters into wisdom.

Homage to the Tathāgata, supremely stable like the palmyra tree.

Whoever retains the names of those buddhas, those Blessed Ones, shall be thoroughly liberated from suffering. Past sins shall be confessed and purified. In this very life one shall become prosperous. One shall not be born in the midst of famine. One shall be thoroughly liberated from all harm.

Tadyathā — tārke, tārke rke, terkā cakre, tarkā tiṣṭhite svāhā.

This dhāraṇī-mantra is called the Wheel of Non-Return. Whoever recites it shall become one who does not turn back. The method of practice is this: abstaining from food, with an undistracted mind, while walking, reciting it by day and by night — conceptual thought will be cleansed away and one will become endowed with mindfulness. It should be recited while holding the foundation of the training.

Tadyathā — ohaṇi, ohaṇi, mohaṇi, huhure, huhure, nubate, jambhaṇi, stambhaṇi svāhā.

By this dhāraṇī-mantra one will attain the patience of non-arising (anutpattikadharmakṣānti). The method of practice is this: holding the foundation of the training for three days, reciting it while walking with an undistracted mind — if it is not accomplished in this life, it will certainly be accomplished in the next.

Tadyathā — care care, yakṣe yakṣe, yakṣa yakṣa, nuddhiṣṭhite, kālapa, aṭiṣṭhite, buddha adhiṣṭhite satva, adhiṣṭhite svāhā.

By this dhāraṇī-mantra all wrongdoing will be purified through confession. It should be recited three times by day and three times by night for seven months.

Tadyathā — maitre, maitri, raktrai, mugte, kṣaye kṣaye, mubate, maitre, buddha adhiṣṭhite svāhā.

By this dhāraṇī-mantra one will attain harmonious patience. The method of practice is this: reciting it three times a day, performing it one thousand times in a single session. Always refraining from sleep, bathing, maintaining cleanliness, wearing clean garments — after eating, reciting with an undistracted mind before a stūpa enshrining relics or before an image of a buddha, and burning durukā incense: all great illnesses will be pacified. These secret mantras should be recited over butter one thousand times, and then poured and applied to the body of the sick person. Whatever renowned medicines there may be, the sick person should recite these mantras over them one thousand times, day by day, three times a day: burning resin, and lighting an oil lamp made of grain oil scented with perfumed water and fine fragrance, and offering a single food dish.

When one recites in accordance with this rite, even the most severe illnesses will be eliminated.

Tadyathā — śuddhe buddhe, āraje, araje, anubade, saṃkalape maitre buddha adhiṣṭhite svāhā.

Reciting one thousand times each day for seven days continuously, with a settled mind, one will attain harmonious patience. It should be recited while holding the foundation of the training.

Tadyathā — sa sa sa sa, mi mi mi mi, gira adhiṣṭhite, jambhakoti, aparājite, kalpavati, jambhakoti, kakāmile, banzini bitini, sanasara, kiṭivajrale, palāte, mamuśes kalāve, nau jare, ayiṣṭhakakale svāhā.

This dhāraṇī-mantra is called the Unmoving. By it one will attain the bodhisattva grounds. The method of practice is this: being pure, having bathed, wearing fresh garments, and holding the foundation of the training, reciting before a stūpa enshrining relics or before an image of a buddha — one will be freed from the fear of kings and from every other fear. It should be recited one thousand times while abstaining from food.

The fragrances for this are: aloeswood, valerian, camphor, juniper, and sandalwood. Incense should also be compounded from these and burned there. Lamps too should be lit using powder made from these. Alternatively, one may offer homage using these fragrances, or mix them with water and sprinkle it. A single food dish should also be placed there, and after reciting the mantra over water infused with these, it should be sprinkled upward.

Whoever performs this rite in this manner will be freed from every kind of fault and liberated from every fear. Until one is freed from such fear, one should recite thirty-three times in the morning. For whoever recites in accordance with this rite, there is no fear or harm from which they will not be liberated. And if one applies this in practice, whatever undertaking one begins, there is nothing that will not be accomplished.

As for one who performs the practice or ties a cord —

or else if it is written out and worn, one will be freed from every harm. A person who possesses merit will attain this in the present life itself. And even if they do not attain it in this life, they will most certainly attain it in the life to come.

The dhāraṇī mantra is as follows: tadyathā — ga bi li ka pi la bin ṭe bhū na ja ra stu mi la ta la mi la ta la ad dva re svāhā.

Whoever recites this dhāraṇī mantra should cultivate loving-kindness toward all sentient beings. The method of practice is this: having bathed well and

donned clean clothing, and without eating food, one should recite it three thousand times before a stūpa containing relics or before an image of a buddha. The incense for this rite is as follows: one should burn aguru, camphor, durukkha, kālanusāri, and śailayaka, and with these as the fumigant, whoever recites in accordance with this rite will be reconciled with all who are angry and hostile toward them.

Taking sandalwood, saffron, sweet wood, karkoṭaka, juniper, and these medicines together, one should recite this dhāraṇī mantra three thousand times over the gathered ingredients and then wear them on the body. Any sorcery or hex will be unable to take hold, and whatever has already been cast will be destroyed. This should be recited by one who holds the trainings and who possesses a mind of loving-kindness.

The dhāraṇī mantra is as follows: tadyathā — ra re ra rā phu pha na ṇe le bi li pha ba kā rā mug te mun dha re svāhā.

This dhāraṇī mantra brings meditative absorption to perfect completion. Whatever treasury one wishes and whatever form of meditative absorption one desires, one will obtain exactly that, and it fulfills all intentions completely. The method of practice is this: being pure, having bathed, wearing clean clothing, and holding the trainings, one should recite before a stūpa containing relics or before an image of a buddha. In each of the ten directions, one should recite the names of the buddhas of those directions thirty-three times each. In each direction, one should also recite the dhāraṇī mantra one hundred and eight times. The incense for this rite is: aguru, camphor, kālanusāri, śailayaka, and durukkha — these are to be burned, and a butter lamp anointed with these should be lit. Water mixed with those medicines is to be set out, and a single portion of food is also to be set out; then whatever one desires in one's mind and petitions to the buddhas, it will come about exactly as desired.

The dhāraṇī mantra is as follows: tadyathā — ti li ga dze śva ra śā ra ā ti ba ti śva ba tā rā ke le ṣi ba ta gu le svāhā.

Through this dhāraṇī mantra one will obtain the divine eye. Eye disease too will be absent. The method of practice is this: having donned clean clothing, one should recite it one hundred and eight times before a stūpa containing relics or before an image of a buddha. This eye medicine is also to be compounded: saffron and white sugar mixed with honey — if this is applied to the eyes, the eyes will not become diseased, and all eye diseases will be absent. As for the incense, the compound is burned. This dhāraṇī mantra is to

be recited one hundred and eight times over that eye medicine. Each day, the mantra is recited seven times over water and then the eyes are washed.

The dhāraṇī mantra is as follows: tadyathā — ba rad tse bi rad tse ku tha le mig tre le ai lai mai lai ṭad gā ṭad gu le svāhā.

This dhāraṇī mantra is for the recollection of the buddhas. The method of practice is this: one who holds the trainings and is pure should recite it nine hundred times before an image of a buddha. The incense compound is burned; a sesame-oil lamp anointed with fragrant substances is lit; an offering bowl is prepared; water anointed with fragrant substances is set out; and a single portion of food is to be set out.

When the mantra has been recited over butter and the butter is then anointed on the head and mouth, one will be freed from all diseases of the head. If it is drunk, mindfulness will arise. One who wishes to learn the Dharma and drinks that butter will find that the faculties become sharp.

Whatever dhāraṇī mantra one undertakes to accomplish, having recited it fully and completely as stated here, all the dhāraṇī mantras and the names of the buddhas are to be recited thirty-three times in each of the ten directions. Whenever the dhāraṇī mantras are recited, the dhāraṇī mantra that is the heart of Amitāyus is to be recited three times by day and three times by night in each of the ten directions. The names of those blessed buddha Bhagavāns are to be recited in each direction.

These dhāraṇī mantras called "The Heart of All Buddhas" are like a wish-fulfilling jewel (cintāmaṇi): just as a holy being of pure virtue who possesses such a jewel obtains whatever is desired, so too whoever recites these mantras will attain buddhahood itself and will be freed from all suffering. That person made this aspiration: "When I have attained the awakening of a buddha, may I then liberate beings." At that time the goddess Vimalaprabha made this aspiration: "Just as I have liberated my elder brother through these dhāraṇī mantras, may all sentient beings likewise be completely liberated through these dhāraṇī mantras."

There will come a time when robbers arrive there, and a time will come when those with red faces seize the land — and this will arise from karma such as the following.

When a wicked youth had appeared and those lawless men arose, they were handed over to the king, and then going to the house of the chief minister,

they carried off his wealth. Now, at the gate of his treasury there lay sleeping a woman, his wife. Suspecting that she might raise the alarm, they took her away and killed her. Thereupon those lawless men were captured and handed over into the custody of those ministers. The children and wives of those lawless men, along with their wealth, were also placed before those chief ministers. The chief minister who was foremost was a virtuous man, and he reclaimed only his own wealth. Then, the sister of that chief minister, lying awake through the night, became aware that the lawless men had come and she saw them being taken before the king. After that, the children and wives of those men were taken by one of the other chief ministers. The wealth was confiscated into the royal treasury, and the other chief minister who had taken the children and wife — even that was not condemned by the king. Then that other minister gave the wife of the chief among the lawless men to his younger brother and his son, and one of the great ones, together with those lawless men, had secretly stolen that minister's own children and wife by night, so that he himself did not recover his children and wife.

At that time those men made this aspiration: "Whenever you obtain a human body, at that time may we seize your wife." The chief among the lawless men — the one who had taken the woman from the treasury gate and led her away — made this aspiration with certainty: "May I be born in the retinue of you, the minister, and whenever you act against me, may I stir up your mind and spread great evil words about you." Then the woman of noble lineage who had noticed the lawless men approaching, when asked about it, said: "I noticed it." As for what you ought to do and what was said by her about what should be done — she made a false statement, out of fear that the guilt would fall upon her own body, out of fear that she would experience it. And so the chief among the lawless men made this aspiration: "May I always dwell in the guise of a friend to this great minister, and yet act as his enemy."

Now, that chief great minister will become the king of Kararāgiri. Another will become the king of the land of Li. The younger brother of the other great minister will become one called Śākula. The son who was born will become one called Puṇyavardana. The one who became chief of the lawless men will become one called Śāpiṭekula. Of the two men who schemed to kill that great minister's wife, one will become one called Akuna, and one will become one called Tupāla. Of the two wives who made aspirations, one will become one called Free from Sorrow, and one will become one called Most Wretched. The great minister's wife who was sleeping by the door of the treasury will be

taken by the king of Kararāgiri away from Piṭkula's wife. The one who became mother of the lawless men will become the mother of those who hold the lawless men, and she too will become their companion. The one who killed the king made this aspiration: "By some means, may I lull you into complacency and then kill you." Therefore the king of Li gave the woman called Akuna to the sorrowless one. The king of Kararāgiri will also take Piṭkula's wife, and from that time on they will become enemies one to another. Those who belonged to the side that does good will do good in the land of Li. Those who had become the lawless men will do evil in the land of Li. And those lawless men who abducted the wife also spoke to that great minister and made this aspiration: "Since you acted rightly and, though you had the means, you let it go and accepted only the barest living from your own wealth, whatever virtue you undertake, may we in that very place become your companions."

Since in a former time Tupāla, when he was a man of the king of Li, had made an aspiration, he will become a companion of the king of Kararāgiri. When that time arrives, the king of Kararāgiri will take Piṭkula's wife, and at that time Piṭkula will spread great evil words about him, and from the thought, "What use is this body?" great despondency will arise in that person. At that time he will recall his former roots of virtue, and will think: "This is the last time I shall be born as a woman. I must call to mind this teaching of the Buddha." From then until the end of his life he will hold to the training rules of a laywoman. At that time, reciting the dhāraṇī mantra called Universal Joy, he will thereby attain the meditative absorption and the patience that allow one to recall past lives. Then, before long, armies of the red-faced ones will overrun that region, and a voice arising of itself will declare: "This is utterly unbearable." At that time, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the gods, and Aprāpā together with her son — all of them, along with the Buddha, the Blessed One, the guardian deities of the land of Li, the Four Great Kings, the yakṣa Sarvaviṇaya, and Aprāpā with her children — will all come to the stūpa at Kapilā. There, before the Blessed One, the dhāraṇī mantra will be proclaimed. At that very time, from that same stūpa, a voice will arise of itself saying: "Armies are coming from the north and from all directions — it will be utterly unbearable." At that time the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the gods, and Aprāpā with her children — all of them — will dress in garments of mourning and come there, saying: "The armies of the red-faced ones are coming. They will destroy the bath-houses, the stūpas, and the monastic assembly halls as well. Lend your aid so that the entire land may not be destroyed." Then at that time Vimalaprabhā spoke

thus: "Please declare what it is I am to do."

"For the sake of the land, even if my own life were to be lost, I have no attachment to it." Then the gods spoke thus: "There is one means and one means only. By all means, let all the people of the land write out the twenty-one chapters of the noble Great Vehicle sūtra, the White Lotus of the Holy Dharma (Skt. Saddharmapuṇḍarīka), and let them recite the great stūpa of the noble Aśva aloud — so as to offer the Dharma to those guardian deities of the categories of teaching of the White Lotus of the Holy Dharma, and to whatever rākṣasas and rākṣasīs are named in that sūtra. Let flavorful foods also be set out. Let those lamps be lit as well." Then Vimalaprabhā spoke thus: "I do not have such power as to compel everyone, for the sake of the land, to copy it out and command them to recite it. Therefore, for the sake of the land, I myself will recite it, and I will also set out the flavorful foods. I will light those lamps as well." When Vimalaprabhā began to recite the White Lotus of the Holy Dharma and to set out the flavorful foods, at that very time the red-faced ones, in the first year, would begin to set out for the land of Li. Then in the third year they would be able to go. At that time the five hundred fierce men who had become companions of the evil-doers would also at that time be seized by fierce men. At that time Vimalaprabhā would become distracted and would no longer recite the White Lotus of the Holy Dharma, and would no longer spread out the flavorful foods. Then the red-faced ones, departing from their own land, would set out in the autumn month to go to the land of Li. At that time the rākṣasī, the king of Li, would be displeased with Vimalaprabhā. Dupāla and Akuna would also at that time become distracted, ceasing to recite it, ceasing to spread out the flavorful foods, and ceasing to light the lamps. Then the gods would engage in battle in the land of Tsaminda and would be defeated. At that time Vimalaprabhā, on the fourteenth day of the invitation ceremony, after reciting the dhāraṇī mantras, said words there that were displeasing to the gods: "You did not recite, as I told you to do, the categories of teaching of the White Lotus of the Holy Dharma each day in accordance with the rite — and because you did not recite it, we have been defeated, and so the Suma will come here." This is the fourth and final fascicle of the Questions of Vimalaprabhā. Then at that time the goddess Vimalaprabhā addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, I beg you to explain what occurred in the past, what will come to pass in the future, and how I may remember it." Then the Blessed One declared: "In a future time, events such as these will come to pass in this land — and they are to be spoken of thus.

The royal dominion of the land of Li will be seized by the Suma. And further, at the time when King Āryajāta led an army against the Śākya land, a certain man among the people of the Śākya land who had become part of the king's retinue took up battle against the allies of the Śākyas, and following his example another man arose and said to him there: 'You have made all the Śākyas take up the training, and yet when enemies came to their land they did not fight — and so in a future time, wherever your relics and teaching have arisen, I have made the aspiration that I will utterly destroy the monastic gardens and the great stūpas by all means.'" Then the Blessed One called out to Avalokiteśvara and declared:

"Dear one, at the time when the Blessed One Ratnagarbha (Jewel-Essence) went to that city, remember that the two of us together received a prophecy of buddhahood there." Then once more the Blessed One declared to Avalokiteśvara: "Dear one, when that time arrives in which the land of Li comes to be in such a state, it will not be destroyed in the slightest by any means whatsoever." Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these words to Excellent Jewel: "Take to heart this instruction as well, just as Avalokiteśvara and I have intended and as the prophecy was given for the land of Uḍḍiyāna." Then, at the time when the Blessed One took fully to heart the approaching army coming to the land of Li, he declared to Avalokiteśvara: "Dear one, when the time arrives that the land of Li comes to be in such a state, open the way. Then at that time, assuming the bodily form of a monk's robes and appearance, he will cause a monk to bring them and come to that land of Li." At that time the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara will rouse those gods who hold the military forces of the land of Li. That monk, too, will later be reborn in the golden land and will be known as Delight in Merit. When he passes away, he will go to a perfectly pure buddha field. When the army comes, on the fifteenth day of the last winter month, at midnight, they will call upon the Stainless Light, saying: "Hear us! An army has come against the land of Li, the king has gone out, and the land has reached an utterly unbearable time." The yellow yakṣa (yakṣa) will also say: "Give instruction to all those gods and yakṣas who have taken into their hands the task of guarding the land of Li together with you, that they must by all means guard the golden land and ensure that it is not destroyed by the enemy forces." They in turn will say: "We will give you a wish-fulfilling jewel (cintāmaṇi) of the most precious kind, by means of which you will be able to accomplish whatever you need, so that the enemy forces will be turned back, the king will return to his own land, and all

will be well — such is what we shall give." At that time they will also give the dhāraṇī mantra by which all the Dharma teachings of those buddhas will be fully understood there. It is as follows:

tadyathā — uka se muka se, ukuru mukuru phuru svāhā — tadyathā — nidzite virdzite, bhaśite, dharma skandha, aparādzite, indravirdzite phu svāhā.

These dhāraṇī mantras are to be recited one hundred and eight times during each sesame-flour ritual offering for the duration of one month, and he said: "I will show you how things will unfold, and I will teach those dhāraṇī mantras." When Certainty has recited the dhāraṇī mantras for a full month, and on the fourteenth day of the following spring month recites the dhāraṇī mantra that the gods caused to be proclaimed, then at that time, in the upper chamber of the meditation hall, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, the Tathāgata Akṣobhya, the Tathāgata Ratnaketu (Jewel-Crest), the Tathāgata Amitābha, and the Tathāgata Dundubhisvara (Drum-Sound),

all the blessed buddhas who had assembled there, however many they were, together deliberated on the Dharma. At that assembly, the blessed buddha named Dharmadhātu — the Source of Dharma — arrived together with as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges River. The thirty-two divine kings also came there. On the fourteenth day, they will come before the one who is to be called Viśuddharaśmi — Certainty of the Stainless Light — and at that time the Brahman bulls of the third group will certainly be turned back in the last month of spring. At that time, the dhāraṇī mantras by which those of the third group will be turned back, by which famine will not arise, and by which the Tathāgata named Source of Dharma will depart — those dhāraṇī mantras too were bestowed.

Homage to the Tathāgata Dharmadhara — Holder of Dharma.

Homage to the Tathāgata of the lineage of Dharmic heroism.

Homage to the Tathāgata Dharmaprabha — Light of Dharma.

Homage to the Tathāgata Dharmaprīti — Joy of Dharma.

Homage to the Tathāgata Dharmasthiti — Abiding in Dharma.

Homage to the Tathāgata Dharmaketu — Crest of Dharma.

Homage to the Tathāgata Dharmatejas — Splendor of Dharma.

Homage to the Tathāgata Dharmeśvara — Lord of Dharma.

Homage to the Tathāgata Dharmadṛḍha — Firm in Dharma.

Homage to the Tathāgata Dharmastūpa — Stupa of Dharma.

Tadyathā: bu bu bu bu, dharma adhiṣṭhite phuḥ, a a a a, dakula adhiṣṭhite, vajre phug care phuḥ, bi bi bi bi phuḥ, sa sa sa sa phuḥ, kau kau kau kau phuḥ, hā hā hā hā phuḥ svāhā.

This dhāraṇī mantra is called "Holding the Earth." Any sentient being who has fallen into a pit, if they recite it one hundred and eight times, will be freed from it. It should also be recited whenever war breaks out.

Thereupon, at that time, the blessed buddhas, for the sake of the one who would be called the youth Vajrasena and the goddess who would be called Certainty — Viśuddharaśmi — on the fourteenth day bestowed the supreme armor of the meteor-king Vijayanātha, Victorious in All Directions.

When at that time the Chinese and the third-group invaders come, then in the land of Delhi kingship will be held, and a ransom will be paid for the sake of the land. The perfume-bath houses, the monastery gardens, and the stupas that were burned by the red-faced ones will be restored. For many years the land will remain in happiness, with good harvests and pleasantness, and at that time these dhāraṇī mantras too were bestowed.

Namo dharma-cintākulasya tathāgatasya. Tadyathā: ca ca ca ca, āṃ ā āṃ ā, rucana gandhe, parura gandhe, rodhanā adhiṣṭhite kula adhiṣṭhite svāhā.

If one wishes to find a treasure, or to find great wealth, one should recite this dhāraṇī mantra one hundred and eight times without eating. The method of accomplishment is as follows: for a period of seven days one takes up the precepts and abstains from meat, eating only rice porridge or grain foods. On the seventh day, without eating, one bathes in the early morning, recites this dhāraṇī mantra, and then on a mountain summit, in the presence of the noble Avalokiteśvara, recites it one thousand times. Upon a lotus of a thousand petals one places seven golden lotuses. Before the bodhisattva one creates a maṇḍala of saffron, and sets out eight kinds of flavorful food anointed with saffron, along with four vessels filled with saffron water. One then performs a fire offering, burning the following: black aloeswood, white sandalwood, red sandalwood, yellow sandalwood — along with their kindling wood — unhusked rice, and śārivā plants. The ritual procedure is as follows: in the maṇḍala, for each fan of the fire one recites once and performs the fire offering. Aloeswood, rock incense, kālīyaka,

camphor, śīlīyaka, saffron, and duruka — one should also fumigate that place with incense made from these substances.

At that time one should also recite this dhāraṇī mantra in accordance with the elaborate ritual procedure (sādhana) as set forth for the vidyā-mantra of Hayagrīva. One should also inquire about the location of the mountain there, or alternatively perform the recitation upon the mountain itself.

Then, at that time, the Blessed One spoke these words to the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara:

"At this time, recall that Rab-ngé, and recite in full this elaborate ritual procedure. The bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara who acts in accordance with the word of the buddha, the Lord of Lords, the King Lord of the Forest, the Lord of Compassion, the Lord of the Radiance of Renunciation, the Lord of Gandharvas, the Lord of Assemblies, the Lord of the World, the Lord of Light, the Lord of Lineage, the Lord of Dharma — all these bodhisattvas will come to that place. And this secret mantra too shall be proclaimed. 'Recite this secret mantra of Rab-ngé,' it is said."

Homage to the buddha. Homage to the Dharma. Homage to the Saṅgha. Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara.

This secret mantra, excellently proclaimed in a former time with pure intent, is to be taught with this ritual procedure out of love and tenderness for sentient beings.

Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, who is endowed with great compassion. Homage to the one who severs all bonds. Homage to the one who utterly pacifies all fears. Homage to the one who holds loving-kindness toward all sentient beings.

This vidyā-mantra, which brings well-being to all sentient beings, is hereby excellently proclaimed.

Tadyathā: cara caraṇi, sara sarate, sara visara, buddha buddha, bodhaya bodhaya, sarva sattva hita, anukampī, bodhaya bodhaya, mite Āryāvalokiteśvarāya, smara smara samayāna, sarva satvānān, maitrecitānān, yas sarva satvanam morśara, kiri kiri kiri ki, kiri kiri kiri ki, kiri kiri, turu turu turu turu, bodhima bodhayā maitre, huru huru, muru muru, śīgham āgaccha āgaccha, sarva sattva hita, ruka mā vī sarva saddheṣu mahākaruṇika, darśayu rūpan, sādhaya sādhaya, vidhyan dehi, dehi me varṇa, dhanaṃ, ghana ghana, surumi, surumi, mahāsurume svāhā. Namō Āryāvalokiteśvarāya, bodhisatvāya, mahāsatvāya, siddhyantu mantrapadā svāhā. Namō ratnatrayāya, namō Āryāvalokiteśvarāya, bodhisatvāya, mahāsatvāya.

Tadyathā: dhuru dhuru, isilimili ni, huhu mamali ni, dudu be namana māsvāhā. Namo ratnatrayāya, namo Āryāvalokiteśvarāya, bodhisatvāya, mahāsatvāya. Tadyathā: mukte vimukte, cchedani cchedani, viccchedani viccchedani, nirmale, maṅgalye, sumukhi vimukhau.

That which liberates one from all fears and from all harms — namely the fear of kings, the fear of thieves, the fear of death, the fear of enemies, the fear of poison, the fear of weapons, the fear of fire, the fear of water, the fear of enemy armies, being in the midst of an army, being in the midst of thieves, being in the midst of lions, being in the midst of tigers, being in the midst of bears, being in the midst of leopards,

being in the midst of fierce wild beasts, being in the midst of black serpents, being placed in iron fetters, being placed in wooden stocks, being put in a leather restraint, being in the midst of great snakes, being in the midst of great elephants, being in the midst of the ocean, being seized by the noose of death — from all of these sufferings one shall be liberated, and from all harms one shall be liberated. O noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord of the World, I pray you protect me, protect me! Hate vihaṭe, hare vihare, sarvavidhanasayapratyarthākammokṣaṇīrīryaṇī svāhā. Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, the Lord, who is endowed with great compassion, who is tenderhearted toward all sentient beings. Homage to the one who holds loving-kindness in mind toward all sentient beings. Homage to the one who utterly liberates all sentient beings from suffering. Homage to the one who severs all bonds. Homage to the one who thoroughly pacifies all fears.

Having paid homage to him, one should recite this — the heart of the noble Avalokiteśvara, the Lord, which accomplishes all works and purposes and which fully liberates from all illnesses: Tadyathā: suru suru suru, turu turu, hili mili, sili sili, disili, jāle jālenai, ukhai mukhe, pukkasi gauri gandhari, ḍombini mataṅgi pukkase, dhure dhure dhure dhure, dharme dharme, dharmiṇe, śānte śāntani māse mukte, vimuktai, jaye vijaye, hili hili mihali mahāli me, hili mili, supane sumanai, surase, amṛtasādhani, nadhe nadhe mukhai, candri candri mukhe, padme padma mukhe, śuddhakanthhe, sūryaprabhe sūryaraśmis triśibrahmasthe brahmasvāre indri, andrakramai, bhaya araje, amṛtamahāprabhe dundubhisvāre madhurasāre, sarvasatva, anukampaya, sādahaya sādahaya, buddham anusmārāhī, dharmam anusmārāhī, saṃgham anusmārāhī, buddhya buddhya, hṛdayam anusmara, bodhaya bodhaya, bodhisatva, me karma sādahaya, barsatvaya svāhā, kārūṇikāya svāhā, karma

me sādḥāya svāhā, namo Āryāvalokiteśvarāya, siddhyantu mantrapadaīḥ svāhā.

When these are recited one hundred and eight times, a lotus fire offering (homa) shall be performed. At that time, these secret mantras are to be recited: Namō ratnatrayāya, namo Āryāvalokiteśvarāya, bodhisatvāya, mahāsatvāya. Tadyathā: khiri khiri, ciri ciri, suru suru, gaccha gaccha, yathā sukhana, Āryāvalokiteśvarāya svāhā. This is to be recited three times. The mantra is also to be recited three times over flowers and incense. One burns agarū incense and sends it forth to the noble Avalokiteśvara, the Lord. All the ritual acts to be performed in this rite are encompassed within the elaborate ritual described previously. Just as the recitation from the maṇḍala of the vidyā mantra of Hayagrīva is to be performed, so too is this rite of the noble Avalokiteśvara, the Lord, to be recited in the same way — the ritual procedure is identical. At that time, this dhāraṇī mantra is also to be recited in the same way as has been described in the context of the offering rite of the golden lotus. At that time, this sūtra is also to be sent to the land of the golden family. At that time, those Blessed Ones, the buddhas, spoke these words: all those people born in the land of Mañcalī under the seal of the Blessed One Śākyamuni, every one of them, are assured of unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening and are entirely irreversible. Among them, the aged and the children all dedicate whatever merit they perform entirely to unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening.

Now, a doubt arises: why does the region of Li wish again and again to be destroyed, yet is unable to be destroyed? At that time, the five hundred bodhisattvas whom the Blessed One, the buddha, had prophesied to unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening will continually take rebirth in that region for as long as the Buddha's teaching endures. Three hundred of them abide in the form of monks and nuns. Two hundred abide in the form of laymen, laywomen, members of royal courts, men, women, the aged, and children. Those bodhisattvas remain in the region of Li for the sake of benefiting sentient beings and protecting the teaching.

One should know that the elder Subhūti, who requests of the Blessed One this Great Vehicle sūtra collection — the Perfection of Wisdom sūtra — is none other than the monk born of diligence.

Now, as to why that region of Li will not be destroyed: it is because the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, the Tathāgatas who are sources of Dharma, and the

bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara have blessed that region so that the stūpas, the pure fragrance halls, and the pleasure groves of the Saṅgha will not be destroyed — those three together having established this. It is understood that the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, together with the Tathāgata Vimalakīrti Candana-sāra who resides at the stūpa of Kapilavastu, performs the buddha's activities in concert.

At that time, in that city, monks who have become human beings, members of the royal court, and many other people arising there — those three groups — think to themselves that they will come to destroy the buddha stūpas and the pleasure groves of the Saṅgha, and they become extremely troubled in mind. Then those Blessed One buddhas cause the thought to arise in those who have become guardians of that stūpa of Kapilavastu: "Let us invite the Blessed One, the buddha, to come to the city." Thereupon the Blessed Ones are invited to come through the city gate in person, just as they actually are. When the Blessed One, the buddha, has come to the city, those Blessed One buddhas who had emitted rays of light — from those rays words arise — give to Subhūti the prophecy: "You, in a future time, in a world-realm known as 'Renowned as a Woman,' will become a Blessed One, a buddha, proclaiming the Dharma, and will be called He Who Bears the Jewel Treasury in His Hand."

At that time, on that very evening, one who had become known as Radiance of Stainless Light heard the sound of the gods weeping. Having heard the sound of weeping, thinking, "Perhaps evil people are coming to this city," he became frightened and terrified and recited dhāraṇī mantras. Then the Blessed Ones spoke these words: "Please invite the Blessed One, the buddha, to come to the city in accordance with the Dharma." Thereupon the Blessed One is invited, in person, to come through the city gate just as he actually is. When the Blessed One, the buddha, has come to the city, those Blessed One buddhas who had emitted rays of light, from which those words arose, give to Subhūti the prophecy: "You, in a future time, in a world-realm renowned as a woman, will become a Blessed One, a buddha, proclaiming the Dharma, called He Who Bears the Jewel Treasury in His Hand." At that time, the one who had become known as Subhūti, and

those Blessed One buddhas who had been emitting rays of light from near the Kapilā stūpa will come together with the Saṅgha of monks from the land of Gold. This will be in order to liberate from that servitude of the herdsmen those people who were formerly enslaved, freeing them from the condition of having taken what was not given. When that report spreads, the herdsmen will

turn back. Then, at that time, through that decisive resolution, the great mass of sentient beings destined to return to cyclic existence will be tamed.

Thereupon the Blessed One, the buddha, declared these words: "Why did you wonder whether, in a future time, herdsmen would come into my land and destroy the fragrant shrines and the pleasure gardens of the Saṅgha? Or why, you may ask, are these called 'herdsmen'? In a past age there arose a king named Brahmadaṭṭa. In his land there appeared a wandering ascetic called Bodhisattva. King Brahmadaṭṭa was driven out of his kingdom and went to the land of another king. Thinking, 'Here I shall eat roots and fruits in turn,' he made himself a shelter of leaves and stayed there. Then another woman who was tending cattle for her master happened to see that wandering ascetic, developed faith in her heart, and each day invited him as a guest to her meal, saying, 'Please enjoy my food.' Those cattle were not under that woman's own authority, since they belonged to her master. Therefore, the food she gave to the wandering ascetic was charged against her account there. The milk she gave to the wandering ascetic, over which she had no authority, counted as taking what was not given. Then the man who was the owner of those cattle was reborn in the land of the Śākyaans. And he made this aspiration: 'In a future time, may I destroy the teachings of the Blessed One.' He is none other than the king who destroys the land of Li — do not think he is anyone else. The one who became the wandering ascetic — that is I, the Blessed One Śākyamuni. The woman who gave milk to the wandering ascetic is the noble woman who, after the buddha had performed his austerities and risen, was the first to offer him food. Thereupon the Blessed One declared: 'The reason that herdsmen and the Red-Faced Ones will come into my land is this: there arose a king named Rūpasāra. At that time, in that king's land, another woman had a son, and she went outside to till her field. Another man also ploughed beside her field. Then the son of that woman stole that man's yoke, wooden trough, flour, and grain. Because of the theft of the flour and the rest, the cattle-owners, the herdsmen, and the Red-Faced Ones will come to the land of Li. The son of that woman who carried away the flour, the yoke, the wooden trough, and the grain — he will become the king of Li. The man whose yoke and other goods were stolen — he will become the king of the Red-Faced Ones at that time. Those cattle will become soldiers at that time. The mother of that man's reborn form will become the mother of the king of Li. The mother of the man who committed theft — she took that flour and offered it as alms to a monk named Citybeautiful, a śrāvaka of the buddha. By that root of virtue she

will attain rebirth as a human being. That man gave flour to his mother, and his mother offered it to the monk Citybeautiful; through the merit accumulated by that, in a future time in the land of Li there will be one called Brave Nurture, and

by that cause he will also become one called Armor of the Victor, and having obtained the royal throne, he will do battle at a meteor-stone. The one who gave the flour — by that cause he will attain rebirth as a human being, and that man will cultivate rice beside a road. Those people who allowed rice belonging to him to be consumed and wasted will at that time become monks, and for that reason they will have to pay restitution from the Saṅgha's wealth for the damage to that region. Those various birds that ate the rice will at that time become the servants of the king of Li. At that time the Blessed One spoke these words: "In this way many wild men will arise in the land of Li. They will be of benefit to Brave Nurture when he is born, and they will do him harm when the Evildoer is born. At that time those five hundred wild men will be sent into the presence of the king, the royal father. Those wild men too will take rebirth in the land of Li and will consume and waste the wealth of the Saṅgha and the wealth of the stūpas. Those wild men, because they commit theft — taking what is not given — will be put to death with their limbs cut off, and by that they will in turn kill the king of Li, Armor of the Victor. In a future time a monk called Pure Moon will arise who will liberate those wild men from cyclic existence. He too is the one who acts as the father of the former buddhas — the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī. Likewise, this bodhisattva Mañjuśrī will in a future time bear the bodily relics of those blessed buddhas of the Fortunate Aeon who are yet to come. And when the blessed buddhas pass completely beyond sorrow into nirvāṇa, the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī will become a brahmin of the Droṇa Gotra, endowed with the Dharma. When the kings make ready to do battle with one another, the brahmin Droṇa Gotra will take up a fine vessel and divide the bodily relics. When the time comes that in the land of Li there have not yet arisen a great number of bodhisattvas, a great many stūpas, images of the buddhas, or beautiful monastic gardens of the Saṅgha, at that time the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī will appear in a city and become a woman of noble lineage.

What are the activities of the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī? He has a form that transforms into whatever is desired in every situation. He appears just as a bodhisattva by nature ought to appear; he appears just as a king appears; he appears just as a queen appears; he appears in the form of an ascetic or a

brahmin; and he enters among all sentient beings of the desire realm in every way. It is like a skilled musician who, being expert in the performance of music, displays every variety of appearance and form. He displays this especially intensely in relation to sentient beings possessed of a mind of passionate attachment. Why does the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī appear in the form of a woman? Because a being possessed of a mind of passionate attachment who is greatly attached to heightened sensual desire for women is exceedingly dull and exceedingly miserly — for that reason the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī appears especially as a woman. And because there are also women who practise the conduct leading to awakening, for that reason too the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī acts in such a way. There are also times when, having been born as a woman, he attains great compassion. Women too will come to feel shame, will come to perceive the faults of cyclic existence, and

will come to renounce men. When the time of the third age arrives and the great stūpas, the many fragrant rest-houses, and the fine pleasure gardens of the Saṅgha are about to be set on fire, the goddess Vimalāprabhā (Immaculate Light) perceives this, and at that moment the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara speaks to that goddess thus: "Dear sister, at the time when the Blessed One goes to the city of Ratnagarbha, I shall become your spiritual friend. Let us two, in that place, recall the aspiration we made together for the sake of awakening and for the sake of fully protecting all sentient beings who are fearful and terrified.

"Dear sister, recall how, at the very time you came to be called Vimalāprabhā, you and Vajrasena together accepted the word of the Blessed One. As for those dhāraṇī mantras, those names of buddhas, and those rays of light which you beheld here while you were practising the conduct of a bodhisattva — proclaim that these are the buddhas, memorize them and write them down, and carry them before your brother. Those rays of light sent forth by those buddhas in the world-realm of Endurance are the hallmark of the Blessed One Śākyamuni in this land of Li, and those bodhisattvas of the Fortunate Aeon will take birth there for the benefit of sentient beings.

"Many bodily relics of those abundant buddhas, those Blessed Ones, that reside in those stūpas of the dharma-kings will come into that goddess's hands, and she will distribute them among those sentient beings for the purpose of veneration. In that land compassion will arise in that goddess, and she will cause it to become a place of worship. Then she shall make an exceedingly beautiful dwelling within the city, so that all the people living in

that city may thereby accumulate merit, uphold the teaching, venerate it, take delight in it, and come to engage in that conduct."

Why is it that the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, discuss the true Dharma for the sake of the land of Li? It is because the land of Li is the hallmark of the Blessed One Śākyamuni, and the hallmark of all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the Fortunate Aeon; because all the buddhas of the Fortunate Aeon will gather at the stūpas of Gośṛṅga, Gomasāla, and Gandhā; and because the land of Li will become the abode of bodhisattvas.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara: "When the time of red faces and warfare arrives, that is when the time has come for you, my younger one, to act. Even with certainty you will knowingly take rebirth again for the benefit of sentient beings. Those buddhas, the Blessed Ones, will send rays of light here and dispatch gifts to the Blessed One Śākyamuni, and those gifts too will be brought here by the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, and out of compassion for fearful and terrified sentient beings, buddha-fields as well will have arisen. Those dhāraṇī mantras and those rays of light the buddhas will accept for the sake of the land of Li, and they will become companions to its people. Bodhisattvas too, so that the land of Li may not be destroyed, will pass away from various buddha-fields and take birth there. When harm comes to the land of Li, the names of those buddhas and

Those names of the dhāraṇī mantras and those rays of light should be written down and placed at the gates of cities, and written upon banners in the midst of armies, and affixed to victory standards. Alternatively, those names should be held, recited, and kept in mind. They will bring benefit for the pacification of enemy armies and of famine, for the increase of virtue, for the purification of misdeeds, and for liberation from illness.

If someone bears a heavy burden of misdeeds, let that person, for twenty-one days, make offerings to the buddhas of the ten directions, and then, before a stūpa that contains relics or before an image of a buddha, recite these names three times a day, morning, noon, and evening. Whatever wholesome aim one desires, one will swiftly attain it, and those rays of light will come to rest upon that person. These names should also be recited when an enemy army approaches. Or alternatively, they may be read seven times each day, once a day. For whoever is in suffering, or is ill, or has any wish whatsoever, they should be recited or read. If someone is unable to read them, let seven knots be tied in a cord, let the names be recited seven times over it, and then let it

be tied on — that person will be liberated from suffering. If it is affixed to the gate of a city, no enemy will be able to enter that city.

Then the Blessed One spoke these words: "When the time comes for the outbreak of the red-faced war and battle, and when the one whom the Blessed One Vajra-host has appointed to duty, the youth Vajra-host, takes up what is called the Armor of Complete Victory, this letter shall be carried to the land of the Golden Lineage, and this letter shall be shown to the king of the Golden Lineage in private — it must not be shown before the eyes of a multitude. The ransom-offering of that land shall also be carried there; some of it shall be dispatched to that place, and some shall be set down upon a meteorite."

Then the Blessed One, having previously declared: "This is how it was before; this is how it will be in the time to come," at that moment entered into meditative absorption into the samādhi called the Vajra Maṇḍala. Then, from that state, he entered into the samādhi called Crest of the Moon, the samādhi called Stainless Light, the samādhi called Immovable, the samādhi called Utterly Without Appearance, the samādhi called Empowerment of Joy, the samādhi called Ornament of All, the samādhi called Heroic Victory Banner, the samādhi called Great Radiance, and the samādhi called Proceeding with Courage. Having entered into these ten samādhis, the Blessed One the buddha emitted from between his brows a ray of light called Great Illumination. From that ray of light ten further rays of light issued forth and went throughout all buddha-fields. Having gone there, they spread out to countless buddha-fields. In all those fields of all the blessed buddhas, in every single one of them, there arose spoken declarations just as had previously been told — concerning the youth Vajra, Vajra-host, and the goddess of Stainless Light — in connection with the land of Li.

Then, at that time, all those blessed buddhas together with the Blessed One Śākyamuni, in mutual accord of intention, pronounced this dhāraṇī mantra called the Vajra Maṇḍala:

Tadyathā — bodhi bodhi, sarva alaṃkāra, vara gata, dharma cakra vara gata, māra sena paragata, aviṣaya paragāta, avidyā pratyāya —

bhava pratyāya, niruddha pratyāya, tathāgata, maraṇa hara, buddhya satyena, nāga satyena, asura satyena, sarva vara satyena —

This dhāraṇī mantra called the Vajra Maṇḍala was proclaimed by all the buddhas. At the very moment the goddess of Stainless Light heard it, she came to understand the dhāraṇī mantra of the Vajra Maṇḍala.

Then, at that time when the buddhas proclaimed this teaching for the sake of the land of Li, the goddess of Stainless Light joined her palms and spoke these words: "I am known to the Blessed One, the buddha himself. From the pure buddha-field — the world-system individually adorned by the light-rays of Vairocana, of the Blessed One, the buddha named Abundantly Blooming Flowers of Omniscient Knowledge, King of Stars, Unstained Petal of the Lotus — I came to this world-system of Endurance to benefit my mother, to seek the sacred Dharma of the White Lotus, and to make aspirational prayers before the Tathāgata Śākyamuni. Having become the laywoman (upāsikā) named Huśa, and having met the brahmin Ocean-of-Dust, I thereafter received a prophecy. At that time I made this aspiration: 'In whatever world-system you shall attain buddhahood, may I too practice the conduct of awakening there.' Having done so, I then came from that world-system — the one called Individually Adorned by the Light-rays of Vairocana — the buddha-field of the Tathāgata Abundantly Blooming Flowers of Omniscient Knowledge, King of Stars, Unstained Petal of the Lotus — to this world-system of Endurance, into the presence of the Blessed One Śākyamuni. And the Blessed One declared: 'The people of this world-system of Endurance are attached and clinging, filled with hatred and swollen with pride and arrogance. For their sake, bodhisattvas take upon themselves great deeds toward one another, clearing away the misdeeds of those beings in every lifetime.'

Having heard this, I then made this aspiration: 'In just the same manner and by the same means by which others come here through the aspiration I have made, may I too come here in that very way.' At that time, for the sake of her who had been my mother in past lives, and in order to prevent her from falling into the lower realms, I took birth. In that earlier time in this world-system of Endurance, having become the laywoman named Huśa, and after the youth of Fine Wealth had questioned me concerning liberation — from that time onward I took birth after birth among human beings in human form. I practiced desire together with sentient beings, and other people saw me as little better than a fool. For the complete liberation of sentient beings, I took on many unbearable births among women — as a queen, as a king's daughter, as an ordinary woman, as a prostitute, as one afflicted by hardship, and as a poor woman — and I worked for the benefit of those born as women, liberating women entirely. Though, driven by the force of my own karma, I practiced sensual desire as I wished, I was unable to bring satisfaction to those sentient beings. Over many lifetimes in this world-system of Endurance I experienced great

sufferings for the sake of sentient beings. Though I became utterly weary of being born as a woman, still the Blessed One enjoined upon me a great task. And so, for countless lifetimes, I shall willingly endure suffering. In order to please the Blessed One Śākyamuni and to accomplish buddhahood itself, I made this great aspiration:

For the benefit of all sentient beings, I shall willingly endure whatever sufferings arise for me in other lifetimes. As for the command the Blessed One gave me — "Protect that realm!" — to this day there are still no men there, nor has the realm yet come to be. Nevertheless, I shall take the excellent vows from among all those buddhas and Blessed Ones, their retinues and assemblies gathered there: gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, gandharvas, kinnaras, great serpents, rākṣasas, humans, and non-humans alike. For as long as I take birth in those lifetimes, even if I am seen to have attachment or aversion as my basis, may I not become sinful on that account. May I obtain an appropriate time of birth, and may I hold to such a course as this. When the time comes for the realm of Li to first arise, may I then, in order to govern that realm, be the very first to become its king. In Li, when the names of those kings are established and the first royal dynasty arises, may I reign as king for seven lifetimes. And I shall build the city called Dngarldan. In the Nepali se'u grove, I shall build a great buddha stūpa. In the realm of Rtā 'jug I shall build a stūpa for the dharmic king. In 'Gumti I shall build a great pleasure garden for the Saṅgha. In Rtsa rma ba na ra as well I shall build a great pleasure garden for the Saṅgha. In Pāyādika I shall build a great fragrant house and a great stūpa, and for as long as I dwell in royal rule I shall perform great deeds. When the time comes that the king passes away, may I be reborn among the gods where the bodhisattva Maitreya (Loving-Kindness) dwells, and may I there recall the meditative absorptions I had attained. Then, taking birth once more in this realm of Li, and becoming a woman's form just as the Blessed One commanded, I shall be born as the daughter of the king of Skar rdo, and be called Rab nges. At that time, may I recall all the dhāraṇī mantras that all the blessed buddhas have taught and that I have understood. May I also recall this very sūtra with great clarity, so that everything may be proclaimed in full. When two armies come to battle and there is work to be done for the sake of the realm of Li, and when the youth Vajrasena, king of Skar rdo, known as the Completely Victorious Armor, reaches the time of giving ransom for the realm of Li — at that time, as I who am called Rab nges, may all those blessed buddhas and all the gods assembled within that retinue become my allies. May

I recall, in all lifetimes, this sūtra, all those dhāraṇī mantras taught along with dhāraṇī explanations, and all the meditative absorptions.

When the goddess Vimalaprabha, the Light of Stainless Purity, had spoken those words, she then attained meditative absorptions — and specifically she attained the meditative absorption called the Swirling Expanse of the White Lotus, the Supreme Dharma of the Mahāyāna Sūtra, by which no one can cause harm to this sūtra. At that moment all the buddhas gave their approval, saying "Excellent!" and declared: "Whenever you set out to compose it, those light rays will abide above, and then whoever recalls this sūtra and practices it most earnestly will attain the meditative absorption called Buddhas Brought to Mind."

The blessed buddhas then spoke a dhāraṇī called the Vajra Maṇḍala. Through the intrinsic nature of this dhāraṇī one comes to understand dhāraṇīs, one purifies meditative absorption, and one recalls everything one has previously heard as Dharma from the blessed buddhas. The goddess Vimalaprabha, the Light of Stainless Purity, likewise comes to understand meditative absorption and dhāraṇīs just as the bodhisattvas understand them. Through that which is called the Armor of Perfect Victory, sovereignty is attained, and no one else is able to create obstacles to it. The function of these is as follows: after reciting them seven times, one should also recite the vidyā-mantra of Hayagrīva, by which sins are purified. If one recites it three times by day and three times by night, within seven years one will come to understand the dhāraṇī of the Vajra Maṇḍala.

When the blessed Buddha had taught this dhāraṇī of the Vajra Maṇḍala, the gods rained down divine flowers upon the Blessed One and sounded the music of the gods, and said these words: "We too shall bestow the dhāraṇīs we have previously heard from the blessed buddhas."

Namas sarva atyudgata. Vajramaṇḍalodtamasya. Tathāgatasya. Kanakābha. Satyasya. Bodhisattvasya. Tadyathā. Buddhasattvena. Dasabiri. Dena hayari. Kurciru pratipadari pabhavatu. Citumatu galara yakadamapatu. Sapajama sarata svāhā.

This dhāraṇī is called the Dhāraṇī that Cuts with the Severance of the Gods. If one recites it one hundred and eight times and makes a fire offering of one hundred and eight stalks of dūrvā grass, then whatever one does, the gods will be unable to obstruct it.

Having made a circular maṇḍala, if one recites it one hundred and eight times and then casts one hundred and eight knots, spirits will be unable to cause harm wherever that recitation takes place, and one will also be unable to be afflicted by sorcery.

Then at that time all those in the assembly spoke this dhāraṇī:

Tadyathā. Sarva devanān. Sarva varṣanaṇa. Nirjita brjite. Skandha nacavan. Nata mana pana gasara. Dada caca papa. Cada mima. Bhasthimi. Daṇḍakaraṇahara. Savara. Deva mara svāhā. Sava pāvarṣakaraṇa svāhā.

This dhāraṇī spoken by all the assembly should be recited one hundred and eight times. One should tie one hundred and eight knots, and then burn the cord, whereupon sorcery will be unable to gain a foothold in that household and illnesses caused by spirits will also be entirely dispelled.

Tadyathā. Rātithākara. Deva baphu jijiri kujidti phu svāhā.

Recite this dhāraṇī seven times over a young boy, tie seven knots in a yak-tail whisk, and then fasten it on him.

Tadyathā. Sarva buddha dama vaṣakarava vara cacarasa sara svāhā.

For all illnesses that arise in the body, recite this dhāraṇī seven times and tie seven knots in a cord, then fasten it on the person.

Then at that time all those in the assembly knelt upon their right knees and made this request: "When the young Vajrasena travels from the land of Karadu to the land of Li, we wish to bestow the dhāraṇī through which heroic deeds will be accomplished in his wake."

Tadyathā. Debu bude debi bi sasa. Vava ratikara svāhā. Tadyathā. Śarakara vā. Jradtsevara. Śadtratra. Naji svāhā.

Those who are setting out on a journey should recite this dhāraṇī seven times, perform a ritual washing, pour water into their hands, recite it seven times again, and then scatter it in the four directions or drink it themselves. Enemies will then be unable to cause them harm, and they will accomplish heroic deeds.

Then the Tathāgata Vajradhvaḥ declared: "Likewise, Vaiśravaṇa's son, and..."

Mahāśvara, Sarvajayin, and Haritī together with her children also spoke, saying: "We too shall bestow these dhāraṇī mantras upon the young Vajrasena so that enemies will be utterly unable to harm him."

Namo vajradhvajasya. Tathāgatasya. Tadyathā. Vajra bi bi bi bi ma ma sa ka. Sumate. Addhare. Adjvale. Vādani svāhā. Namō Maheśvarasya. Namō Vaiśravaṇasya. Namaḥ Sañcayasya. Namō Hāritaye vasuputra. Parivārāya. Tadyathā. Sa sa sa sa. Hā hā hā hā. Priya priya priya priya. Putra putra putra putra. Varda dattakara. Cchandhamule vittveśana kārā svāhā.

When Mahāśvara, Vaiśravaṇa's son, Sarvajayin, and Harītī together with her children had recited these dhāraṇī mantras, they then made this petition: "Just as the Blessed One has appointed us to accomplish heroic deeds, we now wish to recite those dhāraṇī mantras that others cannot withstand. We shall also recite that which will become the armor of complete victory for the divine goddess Nirmalāprabhā and the young Vajrasena, king among stars, and by which transgressions shall be cut off. Whenever an enemy or anyone else sets out to commit harmful, wicked deeds against us, one should recite these two dhāraṇī mantras seven times, make seven knots in a blue thread, burn it, and invoke that person by name — they will then be unable to cause harm. We make this pledge now, just as we pledged at the very first: if we do not fulfill the wishes of the young Vajrasena and the divine goddess Nirmalāprabhā completely, may we thereby deceive the body of all the Blessed Buddhas of the three times."

Then all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas (Skt. garuḍa), gandharvas (Skt. gandharva), kinnaras (Skt. kinnara), great mahoragas (Skt. mahoraga), humans, and non-humans assembled in that retinue all likewise spoke: "Just as the bodhisattvas have made their pledge, we too, all of us, make this pledge: if we do not act accordingly, may we thereby deceive the body of all the Blessed Buddhas of the three times. We will all, with one mind and in full accord, do everything in our power to invest the king of the land of Lī with the armor of complete victory. When warfare and battle arise, we will do everything in our power so that the land of Lī is not destroyed. When those who have gone forth from other lands arrive in the land of Lī, we will ensure that they are received with due care and welcome. Sentient beings who have fled here from other lands shall find a dwelling place, and we will serve as allies in the restoration of those great stūpas and Saṅgha gardens that have been burned by the enemy. For the sake of the land of Lī, we will accept ransoms, and we will give and receive brides in exchange with the enemy, making peace."

Then at that time the Blessed Buddha entrusted the land of Lī to both the divine goddess Nirmalāprabhā and the young Vajrasena. At that time the Blessed Buddha declared to the young Vajrasena: "You shall become king of

the land of Lī, and the divine goddess Nirmalāprabhā shall be your companion and ally. Do everything just as it has been taught in this sūtra. Now, at the time when you return to the land of the golden lineage, when you hear the news that the enemy's army has come to the land of Lī —"

Go to the land of Lī without hesitation, and if you send a messenger there, he will not come to you — he will go to the land of Lī and the land of Guzan. Send word by letter saying: 'Make alliance with me and give me the territory.' Then at that time you shall become king of the land of Lī. The one called Indra's Armor shall become king of the land of Karṇa, and he too shall become your ally in becoming king of the land of Lī. When harm comes to the land of Karṇa, do everything in your power to prevent that harm from occurring. First make an alliance with Indra's Armor as well — he will become an ally in these undertakings. All the people of Karṇa, however many there may be, shall also become allies.

There is a hero named Akuna. In a former life, when he was known as Jñānakīrti, he built a temple called Dharmatīra. Therefore you should seek out Akuna, for he will become your ally in taking the territory. Why is this? Because the two of you made aspirations together in a former life. This man named Akuna was formerly a king whose wife was abducted by barbarians and was never recovered. You were the king's great minister, and you were one who brought joy.

Then at that time the Blessed Buddha declared to the young Vajrasena: "Young Vajrasena, you shall become king of the land of Lī, bearing the title King of Victorious Armor, and you shall hold royal power for thirty years. Having become a lay practitioner, you shall attain the fruit of fully giving your body for the sake of the land of Lī."

Then at that time the Blessed One declared to the divine goddess Nirmalāprabhā: "When you become known in the land of Lī as Rabnge, take up this sūtra. Enter into it, spread it widely, and send it to those without family in the land of Karṇa as well. Rays of light shall abide upon you. At the time when you come to understand the dhāraṇī mantras, the Blessed Buddha himself shall speak to you, and the gods too shall speak at length in such a way as to enable you to carry out your work."

Then at that time the Blessed One declared to the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara: "Dear brother, just as when the Blessed One Ratnagarbha departed for the city and the two of us received the prophecy of our own buddhahood, and just as

at that time I made the aspiration, 'May I become the protector of all sentient beings in the ten directions who are frightened and terrified' — call to mind that time of making that aspiration, and now receive this entrustment: this land of Lī of mine, the divine goddess Nirmalāprabhā, and the young Vajrasena."

Then the Blessed One declared to the bodhisattvas Samantabhadra, Mañjuśrī, Ākāśagarbha, Mahāsthāmaprāpta, the King of Medicine, Pradānasūra, Kṣitigarbha, Maitreya, and the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara: "These are the elder brothers, companions, and constant associates of this one from former times: the god of variety, the sovereign god, the king of sovereign trees, the sovereign of compassion, the sovereign of dhāraṇī, the sovereign of renunciation, the sovereign of light, the sovereign of fragrance, the sovereign of assemblies, the sovereign of the world, luminosity, and the sovereigns of lineage."

Then the Blessed One called out to all those bodhisattvas, Samantabhadra and the rest, and declared: "Sons of good family, receive and uphold this sūtra of mine of the Great Vehicle, together with the young Vajrasena and the goddess Vimalaprabā."

Then the Blessed One called to Vajrapāṇi, the lord of secrets, and declared: "You who are ever my constant attendant — to you I entrust this sūtra, together with the young Vajrasena and the goddess Vimalaprabā."

And to the yakṣa lord Vaiśravaṇa, the yakṣa Sarvajayin, the divine son Sthiramati, the nāga king Anavatapta, Hāritī together with her children, the kings of the gods of the thirty-two divine palaces, all those gathered in that assembly, the buddha Blessed Ones who emit rays of light, and all the bodhisattvas assembled from the ten directions — to all of them he entrusted this sūtra, together with the Lī region, the young Vajrasena, and the goddess Vimalaprabā, and having entrusted it with the sacred act of full entrustment, he fully entrusted it.

Then once more the Blessed One declared to all of them: "Act as companions in accordance with what I have said and in accordance with the pledges you yourselves have made, and bring to perfect completion my every intention in all respects and in all directions, and do so in such a way that there is no deviation. The hardships I have endured, exceedingly many, while wandering in saṃsāra through countless aeons — such things were not done even by other bodhisattvas. Those sentient beings in my own surrounding realm whom

I have not yet brought to full maturation shall in the future come to reside in the retinue of the Li region and shall attain full liberation through my Dharma."

Then the Blessed One called to the bodhisattvas of the Fortunate Aeon and declared: "To all of you I entrust this sūtra, together with the Li region, the young Vajrasena, and the goddess Vimalaprabā." At the time when the buddha Blessed One entrusted to all the buddhas, all the bodhisattvas, all the gods, and all the assembled retinue this sūtra, the Li region, the young Vajrasena, and the goddess Vimalaprabā, a rain of divine flowers fell upon the buddha Blessed One Śākyamuni. The gods sounded the music of the gods. A rain of divine ornaments also fell. And likewise all those in that assembly made offering to the Blessed One with offerings befitting him. Those buddha Blessed Ones also sent forth exceedingly many rays of light into this world-realm of Sahā. The sentient beings dwelling in this world-realm of Sahā beheld those buddha Blessed Ones together with the circles of their retinues. And those dwelling there beheld the Tathāgata Śākyamuni together with the circle of his retinue and the world-realm of Sahā, and all the retinue, gods and humans, beheld one another.

Then at that time the monk Ānanda rose from his seat, joined his palms together, and addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, in the future, whoever reads this sūtra, contemplates it, hears it, masters it, questions others about it, or guides others to inquire into it — how great will the accumulation of merit of such a person grow?"

The Blessed One declared: "Rather than giving gifts to all the beings, however many there may be, dwelling within eighty-four thousand buddha-fields — whoever upholds this sūtra,

recites it or reads it aloud — the accumulation of merit of such a person will be far greater still. In brief, just as the accumulation of merit will grow for one who realizes the third fruit, so great, I declare, will the accumulation of merit grow for such a person."

Then the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, gandharvas, kinnaras, great serpents, rākṣasas, and all those of the retinue spoke with one voice: "Wherever this sūtra is proclaimed, may we who are gathered in this assembly be present there. And if the youth Vajrasena and the goddess Vimalaprabha are not granted the dhāraṇī mantras, and if this pledge is broken, then may we be counted as having deceived the bodies of all the Blessed Ones, the buddhas of the three times, and as having committed whatever sins are found

among the actions of uninterrupted gravity." Then from those very rays of light there arose spoken words, and the proclamation rang out: "Wherever this sūtra is proclaimed, there shall we come."

Then Ānanda and all those of the retinue implored: "Blessed One, what is the name of this teaching of Dharma? How should we hold it?" The Blessed One declared: "The name of this sūtra is the Crown of the Dharma, and it may also be called the Heart of the Dharma of All Buddhas, and it may also be called the Inquiry of Vimalaprabha. Hold it by these names."

Then the Blessed One Śākyamuni declared: "All those teachings of Dharma that I have set forth are gathered together within this very sūtra."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, those bodhisattvas, the venerable Ānanda, all those of the retinue, and the world with its gods, humans, and asuras rejoiced, and they offered heartfelt praise for what the Blessed One had taught.

The Great Vehicle sūtra called the Inquiry of Vimalaprabha is hereby complete.

Translator's Notes

- The text is the opening of the Vimalaprabhāparipṛcchā, a sūtra connected with the land of Li (identified in the tradition with Khotan). The phrase rendered "the ground of my loving-kindness" (byang chub kyi sa, or here bya[m]s pa'i sa) may carry the resonance of "the land of Maitreya's connection," since byams pa can also be the name Maitreya; the phrase could thus allude to a future connection with Maitreya. This is genuinely ambiguous and contextually significant. The place name Agumatira (a[']gu ma ti ra) is a phonetic transcription of what appears to be an Indic or Central Asian toponym and is left in transliteration, as no standard identification is certain.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as the Tibetan itself ends mid-construction. The translator has rendered it faithfully without inventing a completion.

The phrase "God of Gods" rendering རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་པོ་ is a standard honorific title for the Buddha found in Mahāyāna sūtras, meaning he surpasses even the gods; it is retained as such here.

The sūtra referred to as རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་པོ་, "the Heart of the Sun," appears to be a self-referential title for the text being transmitted — a common feature of Mahāyāna sūtras.

The verse "When I, the gods, have passed beyond sorrow" reflects the Tibetan རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་པོ་ཀྱི་པོ་, where the Buddha addresses the divine assembly and speaks in the first person about his own nirvāṇa, with རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་པོ་ functioning as a vocative. This reading is preserved accordingly.

- The Tathāgata epithet rendered "Priyajaya, whose Dharma grows and flourishes" translates bu sdug rgyal ba'i chos 'phel ba; bu sdug could mean "beloved son" or could be a proper name; the rendering treats it as a partial name-epithet compound, and the precise Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain.

The bodhisattva names Śrīḡyan and Nāṅsal are Tibetan epithets without certain Sanskrit equivalents recoverable from this context; they are rendered by meaning in parenthetical glosses and left in transliterated Tibetan form for consistency.

The dhāraṇī syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic rendering; no restoration to standard Sanskrit orthography has been attempted, as the forms are irregular and the underlying Sanskrit originals cannot be confidently reconstructed.

- The name "Li yul" refers to the kingdom of Khotan (ancient Khotanese kingdom in Central Asia), a land of particular significance in Tibetan Buddhist historical and prophetic literature. The text appears to be situating a protective dhāraṇī in the context of Khotan's defense and prosperity.

The phrase rendered "Courageous Advance" for dpa' bar 'gro ba'i ting nge 'dzin corresponds to a specific named samādhi, likely Skt. śūravikrāmitasamādhi or similar; the exact Sanskrit title of this absorption is not confirmed in the passage itself.

The epithet of the bodhisattva rendered "Stainless Light" (Tib. *dri ma med pa'i 'od*) corresponds to Skt. *Vimalaprabha*, a bodhisattva named in several dhāraṇī texts.

The nāga king name "gdon la snyems pa" is rendered provisionally as "Takṣaka the Proud" — the Tibetan literally means "proud of being possessed" or "proud/arrogant one with possession"; the identification with Takṣaka is uncertain, and this may be a different nāga king entirely. This is a genuinely uncertain identification.

• The list of named rays of light is a ritual enumeration typical of dhāraṇī literature; the Tibetan terms are rendered straightforwardly by their literal meanings, as is standard in such catalogs. The ray of light called "Victory Banner of Indra" appears twice in the sequence, which reflects the source text. The term rendered "Free of Contagion" for རྩུབ་རྩིས་མེད་ translates literally as "free of epidemic or plague," here used as a qualifying epithet within a compound name. The phrase ལོག་རྩིས་ཀྱི་ཕྱོད་པོ་འཁོར་བཞུགས་པའི་སྐུ་ཡི་ཆོས་ཀྱི་འཛུལ་པ་ཅན་པོ།, rendered "who thoroughly swallows weapons," is an unusual epithet; the image is of a buddha whose power neutralizes all weapons.

• Several of the ray-of-light names in this passage are transliterations of Sanskrit syllables or terms that have been phonetically rendered into Tibetan without semantic translation, including Kokara, Jatsaraya, and the mantra sequences. These are preserved as phonetic renderings since their Sanskrit originals are unclear or they function as dhāraṇī syllables rather than meaningful epithets. The mantra strings (tadyathā formulas) are rendered as close phonetic approximations of the Tibetan transcription; the underlying Sanskrit is evidently corrupt or non-standard in the Tibetan witnesses, and no emendation has been introduced into the body. The term rendered "Form of Tingling" for རྒྱུ་ལྡན་གྱི་ཁུངས་ཀྱི་རྣམ་ཐང་ is genuinely uncertain; རྒྱུ་ལྡན་ can refer to a tingling or gooseflesh sensation, but in this context another sensory or aesthetic meaning is possible.

- The term translated as "illness of the monthly sign" renders ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་, which most likely refers to menstrual disorders or gynaecological conditions associated with the menstrual cycle; the Tibetan is somewhat elliptical here.

The phrase 𑖀𑖩𑖦𑖪𑖫𑖧𑖨𑖱𑖻𑖿𑖫𑖾𑖨𑖢𑖰𑖪𑖳𑖽𑖲𑖯𑖮𑖬𑖭𑖴𑖱𑖾𑖨𑖢𑖰𑖪𑖳𑖽𑖲𑖯𑖮𑖬𑖭𑖴𑖱𑖾 refers to those buddhas having been companions or associates of Śākyamuni during his bodhisattva career across past lives; "companions" captures the sense adequately.

The text here is part of a Tibetan Buddhist scripture concerning Liyul, identified in the tradition as referring to the region of Khotan (in present-day Xinjiang), a historically significant Buddhist land. The passage emphasises that buddhas and bodhisattvas took birth there specifically to protect and sustain the Dharma in that land.

- The three place-names in the sentence beginning "those three" are unclear. "Dngarldanpa"

renders dngarldan, which may be a proper toponym; "the one marked by the pig" renders phagkis mtshon pa'i grong khyer, which could be a place-name derived from a pig emblem or symbol. The text appears to list three specific localities in Liyul whose identities cannot be determined with certainty from context alone.

The dhāraṇī mantra is transliterated from Tibetan phonetic Sanskrit. The rendering follows the Tibetan syllable-by-syllable; the underlying Sanskrit is corrupt or highly variant in transmission, and no reliable reconstruction is possible.

- The buddha-field name "Adorned Individually by the Light Rays of Vairocana" and the Tathāgata name "The Fully Blossoming Flower of Direct Realization, the Stainless Star-King of the Lotus Petal" are long compound epithets rendered as literally as readability allows; these are likely ceremonial names specific to this text rather than widely attested figures.

The phrase rendered "Sahāpati" in the preceding passage and here as "Sahāpati" refers to Brahmā Sahāmpati, the lord of the Sahā world-realm, a common protective deity in Buddhist literature.

- The epithet "Red-Faced Ones" refers to Tibetan enemies conventionally identified in the text as a group who raid Liyul; the identification is left as is since the preceding context uses this term and its precise ethnic or demonic referent is a matter of ongoing scholarly discussion.

Vaiśravaṇa is one of the Four Great Kings, guardian of the north and lord of yakṣas and wealth. Lamakontī is a transliteration of a name that may represent a Sanskrit original; its exact Sanskrit form is uncertain.

Haritī is a well-known semi-divine figure associated with children; her Tibetan name here, Awokmā Buwa, rendered as "Haritī," follows the standard identification of this figure in the tradition.

The final line of the verse passage is incomplete as transmitted, ending mid-stanza. This appears to be a textual break, and no continuation is supplied here.

- "Kuntū Gyalwa" is a Tibetan proper name rendered phonetically; no Sanskrit equivalent is clearly attested and its identification is left open.

"Kaspara" is a place name rendered phonetically from the Tibetan; it likely refers to Kaśmīr or a region near it, but the identification is not certain enough to embed in the text.

The phrase rendered "foul meditative absorption" translates mi gtsang ting 'dzin, literally "unclean samādhi." This unusual expression may refer to a spiritually impure or corrupted state of concentration; the exact doctrinal reference is uncertain.

The transition from verse to prose in this passage follows the Tibetan original, which shifts mid-passage into unmetered prose for the royal queen's speech.

- The passage contains an unusual self-address structure in the nephew's speech to Vimalaprabha, where he appears to prophesy his own future rebirth and her future spiritual state in notably indirect terms. The statement about attaining "an absorption that is impure, without any scriptural basis" is syntactically and doctrinally opaque in the Tibetan; the rendering preserves the apparent meaning but the exact doctrinal referent of "impure absorption without scriptural basis" is unclear from context alone and may reflect a specific local or narrative theological convention of this text.

The name Āju rendered here is a transliteration of the Tibetan proper name Ā-zu; it appears to be a local yakṣa deity and no Sanskrit equivalent is recoverable with confidence.

- The dhāraṇī mantra syllables are rendered as they appear in the Tibetan transliteration of Sanskrit. The reconstruction is phonological rather than semantic; no standard Sanskrit edition

has been consulted for this passage, and variant readings may exist. The term "Gomasalagandha" is kept as a proper name for the stūpa, as the Tibetan phonetically renders a Sanskrit toponym whose precise form is uncertain. "Rilangu" likewise is a Tibetan phonetic rendering of a place name; its Sanskrit or local original is not recoverable from this passage alone.

- The name "Semkyi Tsik" is left in transliterated Tibetan because the passage treats it as a proper epithet conferred at that moment rather than a fully transparent descriptive title; it appears to mean something like "Word of the Mind of Awakening" but functions as a name in context.

The "King of Karādu" renders 𐎧𐎠𐎡𐎢𐎣𐎤𐎥𐎦𐎧𐎨𐎩𐎪𐎫𐎬𐎭𐎮𐎯𐎰𐎱𐎲𐎳𐎴𐎵𐎶𐎷𐎸𐎹𐎺𐎻𐎼𐎽𐎾𐎿𐏀𐏁𐏂𐏃𐏄𐏅𐏆𐏇𐏈𐏉𐏊𐏋𐏌𐏍𐏎𐏏𐏐𐏑𐏒𐏓𐏔𐏕𐏖𐏗𐏘𐏙𐏚𐏛𐏜𐏝𐏞𐏟𐏠𐏡𐏢𐏣𐏤𐏥𐏦𐏧𐏨𐏩𐏪𐏫𐏬𐏭𐏮𐏯𐏰𐏱𐏲𐏳𐏴𐏵𐏶𐏷𐏸𐏹𐏺𐏻𐏼𐏽𐏾𐏿𐐀𐐁𐐂𐐃𐐄𐐅𐐆𐐇𐐈𐐉𐐊𐐋𐐌𐐍𐐎𐐏𐐐𐐑𐐒𐐓𐐔𐐕𐐖𐐗𐐘𐐙𐐚𐐛𐐜𐐝𐐞𐐟𐐠𐐡𐐢𐐣𐐤𐐥𐐦𐐧𐐨𐐩𐐪𐐫𐐬𐐭𐐮𐐯𐐰𐐱𐐲𐐳𐐴𐐵𐐶𐐷𐐸𐐹𐐺𐐻𐐼𐐽𐐾𐐿𐑀𐑁𐑂𐑃𐑄𐑅𐑆𐑇𐑈𐑉𐑊𐑋𐑌𐑍𐑎𐑏𐑐𐑑𐑒𐑓𐑔𐑕𐑖𐑗𐑘𐑙𐑚𐑛𐑜𐑝𐑞𐑟𐑠𐑡𐑢𐑣𐑤𐑥𐑦𐑧𐑨𐑩𐑪𐑫𐑬𐑭𐑮𐑯𐑰𐑱𐑲𐑳𐑴𐑵𐑶𐑷𐑸𐑹𐑺𐑻𐑼𐑽𐑾𐑿𐒀𐒁𐒂𐒃𐒄𐒅𐒆𐒇𐒈𐒉𐒊𐒋𐒌𐒍𐒎𐒏𐒐𐒑𐒒𐒓𐒔𐒕𐒖𐒗𐒘𐒙𐒚𐒛𐒜𐒝𐒞𐒟𐒠𐒡𐒢𐒣𐒤𐒥𐒦𐒧𐒨𐒩𐒪𐒫𐒬𐒭𐒮𐒯𐒰𐒱𐒲𐒳𐒴𐒵𐒶𐒷𐒸𐒹𐒺𐒻𐒼𐒽𐒾𐒿𐓀𐓁𐓂𐓃𐓄𐓅𐓆𐓇𐓈𐓉𐓊𐓋𐓌𐓍𐓎𐓏𐓐𐓑𐓒𐓓𐓔𐓕𐓖𐓗𐓘𐓙𐓚𐓛𐓜𐓝𐓞𐓟𐓠𐓡𐓢𐓣𐓤𐓥𐓦𐓧𐓨𐓩𐓪𐓫𐓬𐓭𐓮𐓯𐓰𐓱𐓲𐓳𐓴𐓵𐓶𐓷𐓸𐓹𐓺𐓻𐓼𐓽𐓾𐓿𐔀𐔁𐔂𐔃𐔄𐔅𐔆𐔇𐔈𐔉𐔊𐔋𐔌𐔍𐔎𐔏𐔐𐔑𐔒𐔓𐔔𐔕𐔖𐔗𐔘𐔙𐔚𐔛𐔜𐔝𐔞𐔟𐔠𐔡𐔢𐔣𐔤𐔥𐔦𐔧𐔨𐔩𐔪𐔫𐔬𐔭𐔮𐔯𐔰𐔱𐔲𐔳𐔴𐔵𐔶𐔷𐔸𐔹𐔺𐔻𐔼𐔽𐔾𐔿𐕀𐕁𐕂𐕃𐕄𐕅𐕆𐕇𐕈𐕉𐕊𐕋𐕌𐕍𐕎𐕏𐕐𐕑𐕒𐕓𐕔𐕕𐕖𐕗𐕘𐕙𐕚𐕛𐕜𐕝𐕞𐕟𐕠𐕡𐕢𐕣𐕤𐕥𐕦𐕧𐕨𐕩𐕪𐕫𐕬𐕭𐕮𐕯𐕰𐕱𐕲𐕳𐕴𐕵𐕶𐕷𐕸𐕹𐕺𐕻𐕼𐕽𐕾𐕿𐖀𐖁𐖂𐖃𐖄𐖅𐖆𐖇𐖈𐖉𐖊𐖋𐖌𐖍𐖎𐖏𐖐𐖑𐖒𐖓𐖔𐖕𐖖𐖗𐖘𐖙𐖚𐖛𐖜𐖝𐖞𐖟𐖠𐖡𐖢𐖣𐖤𐖥𐖦𐖧𐖨𐖩𐖪𐖫𐖬𐖭𐖮𐖯𐖰𐖱𐖲𐖳𐖴𐖵𐖶𐖷𐖸𐖹𐖺𐖻𐖼𐖽𐖾𐖿𐗀𐗁𐗂𐗃𐗄𐗅𐗆𐗇𐗈𐗉𐗊𐗋𐗌𐗍𐗎𐗏𐗐𐗑𐗒𐗓𐗔𐗕𐗖𐗗𐗘𐗙𐗚𐗛𐗜𐗝𐗞𐗟𐗠𐗡𐗢𐗣𐗤𐗥𐗦𐗧𐗨𐗩𐗪𐗫𐗬𐗭𐗮𐗯𐗰𐗱𐗲𐗳𐗴𐗵𐗶𐗷𐗸𐗹𐗺𐗻𐗼𐗽𐗾𐗿𐘀𐘁𐘂𐘃𐘄𐘅𐘆𐘇𐘈𐘉𐘊𐘋𐘌𐘍𐘎𐘏𐘐𐘑𐘒𐘓𐘔𐘕𐘖𐘗𐘘𐘙𐘚𐘛𐘜𐘝𐘞𐘟𐘠𐘡𐘢𐘣𐘤𐘥𐘦𐘧𐘨𐘩𐘪𐘫𐘬𐘭𐘮𐘯𐘰𐘱𐘲𐘳𐘴𐘵𐘶𐘷𐘸𐘹𐘺𐘻𐘼𐘽𐘾𐘿𐙀𐙁𐙂𐙃𐙄𐙅𐙆𐙇𐙈𐙉𐙊𐙋𐙌𐙍𐙎𐙏𐙐𐙑𐙒𐙓𐙔𐙕𐙖𐙗𐙘𐙙𐙚𐙛𐙜𐙝𐙞𐙟𐙠𐙡𐙢𐙣𐙤𐙥𐙦𐙧𐙨𐙩𐙪𐙫𐙬𐙭𐙮𐙯𐙰𐙱𐙲𐙳𐙴𐙵𐙶𐙷𐙸𐙹𐙺𐙻𐙼𐙽𐙾𐙿𐚀𐚁𐚂𐚃𐚄𐚅𐚆𐚇𐚈𐚉𐚊𐚋𐚌𐚍𐚎𐚏𐚐𐚑𐚒𐚓𐚔𐚕𐚖𐚗𐚘𐚙𐚚𐚛𐚜𐚝𐚞𐚟𐚠𐚡𐚢𐚣𐚤𐚥𐚦𐚧𐚨𐚩𐚪𐚫𐚬𐚭𐚮𐚯𐚰𐚱𐚲𐚳𐚴𐚵𐚶𐚷𐚸𐚹𐚺𐚻𐚼𐚽𐚾𐚿𐛀𐛁𐛂𐛃𐛄𐛅𐛆𐛇𐛈𐛉𐛊𐛋𐛌𐛍𐛎𐛏𐛐𐛑𐛒𐛓𐛔𐛕𐛖𐛗𐛘𐛙𐛚𐛛𐛜𐛝𐛞𐛟𐛠𐛡𐛢𐛣𐛤𐛥𐛦𐛧𐛨𐛩𐛪𐛫𐛬𐛭𐛮𐛯𐛰𐛱𐛲𐛳𐛴𐛵𐛶𐛷𐛸𐛹𐛺𐛻𐛼𐛽𐛾𐛿𐜀𐜁𐜂𐜃𐜄𐜅𐜆𐜇𐜈𐜉𐜊𐜋𐜌𐜍𐜎𐜏𐜐𐜑𐜒𐜓𐜔𐜕𐜖𐜗𐜘𐜙𐜚𐜛𐜜𐜝𐜞𐜟𐜠𐜡𐜢𐜣𐜤𐜥𐜦𐜧𐜨𐜩𐜪𐜫𐜬𐜭𐜮𐜯𐜰𐜱𐜲𐜳𐜴𐜵𐜶𐜷𐜸𐜹𐜺𐜻𐜼𐜽𐜾𐜿𐝀𐝁𐝂𐝃𐝄𐝅𐝆𐝇𐝈𐝉𐝊𐝋𐝌𐝍𐝎𐝏𐝐𐝑𐝒𐝓𐝔𐝕𐝖𐝗𐝘𐝙𐝚𐝛𐝜𐝝𐝞𐝟𐝠𐝡𐝢𐝣𐝤𐝥𐝦𐝧𐝨𐝩𐝪𐝫𐝬𐝭𐝮𐝯𐝰𐝱𐝲𐝳𐝴𐝵𐝶𐝷𐝸𐝹𐝺𐝻𐝼𐝽𐝾𐝿𐞀𐞁𐞂𐞃𐞄𐞅𐞆𐞇𐞈𐞉𐞊𐞋𐞌𐞍𐞎𐞏𐞐𐞑𐞒𐞓𐞔𐞕𐞖𐞗𐞘𐞙𐞚𐞛

- The name "Ajātaśatru" is rendered from the Tibetan "ma skyes dgra'i grong khyer skyong ba" — literally "guardian of the city of the Unborn Enemy," which is a standard Tibetan rendering of Ajātaśatru. Here it appears to designate a city guardian or administrator associated with that king's city rather than the king himself, which is slightly unusual and may reflect a local narrative convention in this text.

The phrase rendered "attain emergence from saṃsāra" translates 'khor ba nas 'byung ba 'thob pa, literally "obtain emergence from cyclic existence," a somewhat unusual formulation. It likely means liberation or nirvāṇa, but the phrasing is deliberately understated in the original.

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the final list of assembly members, indicating the passage ends abruptly and continues in the next section. The term rendered "meteoric iron king" reflects the literal meaning of the Tibetan "king of meteoric iron stone," which likely refers to a king of a region or people associated with iron, possibly a specific geo-political or legendary entity in the narrative context. The name of the divine son rendered as Supraṭiṣṭhitamati is a standard back-reconstruction from the Tibetan "blo gros rab tu brtan pa." The goddess rendered as Haritī follows the standard identification of lha mo 'phrog ma in this textual tradition.

- The term rendered "meteoric iron" for རྩམ་རྩམ་ translates literally as "star stone" and likely refers to meteoritic iron or a precious stone of celestial origin; this is a contextually significant translation choice as the object appears to be an item of diplomatic or economic value in the narrative. The phrase རྩམ་རྩམ་ ("Red-Faces") refers throughout to a foreign invading people; the identity is left as a descriptive rendering following the literal Tibetan, consistent with the preceding passage's treatment. The final samādhi name རྩམ་རྩམ་རྩམ་རྩམ་ is rendered interpretively as "Recollection of the Buddha's Mind" to distinguish it from the earlier Buddhānusmṛti; some uncertainty attaches to whether this should instead be "Taking the Buddha to Mind" or simply "Buddhacetanā."

- The phrase rendered "the thirty-two lords of power on earth" reflects a list of worldly sovereign deities; the number thirty-two corresponds to the traditional enumeration of earthly sovereignty deities associated with Śakra's assembly, here specified as ruling over the earth rather than the heavens.

The dhāraṇī mantra is transliterated from phonetic Tibetan representing degraded Sanskrit syllables. The name "Stability of the Horse" renders the Tibetan rta gnas, which likely corresponds to a Sanskrit name such as Aśvasthāna or similar.

The phrase "rakṣasas of the Delighter class" renders rangs byed kyi srin po; rangs byed means "one who delights" or "one who causes joy," likely a class-name or epithet for a subdivision of raksasas. The meaning of srid sgrub kyi sgra mi snyan pa rnam, rendered "by means of the

accomplishment of existence the discordant sounds," is syntactically compressed and may refer to a second category of beings overcome by this mantra rather than a method.

The "five products of a cow" is the standard ritual purifying substance in Indian ritual contexts, consisting of milk, curds, clarified butter, urine, and dung.

- The term rendered "armor" for རྒྱུ་མཛུགས་ reflects a standard reading of this word as protective battle gear; some manuscripts may vary. The term རྒྱུ་མཛུགས་ལྗོངས་ (literally "food of the dead" or "corpse food") refers to food offerings set out before deity images in ritual contexts that are periodically renewed — rendered as "food offerings" throughout for clarity in narration.
- The passage closes mid-sentence with "For one who has dysentery, or," faithfully reflecting the abrupt cut in the supplied Tibetan, which ends at རྒྱུ་མཛུགས་ལྗོངས་ without completing the sentence. The translation preserves this open ending exactly as given.

The mantra syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic rendering, following the same conventions as the preceding passage. Some syllables resist confident Sanskrit reconstruction and are rendered phonetically as given.

Vajradhvaja rendered from རྒྱུ་མཛུགས་ལྗོངས་ལྗོངས་, literally "Vajra Victory Banner," treated here as a proper epithet or name.

- The term rendered "Stable Abode" translates the ritual designation rta gnas, which in context refers to a specific vidyā rite or protective installation; the precise identity of this rite is unclear from this passage alone and would require broader manuscript context to confirm.

The mantra syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic rendering; these are liturgical phonemes rather than normalized Sanskrit grammar, and minor variants from other witnesses are possible.

"Dūruka" is a fragrant substance identified in Indian ritual texts; its precise botanical identity is debated in scholarship.

The epithet "Utterly Fearsome Yet Free from Timidity" renders rab tu 'jigs shing bag tsha ba dang bral ba, a standard Tathāgata name formula, here combined in an unusual pairing; no emendation has been made.

- The phrase rendered as "the youthful Vajra-host" translates a compound that likely refers to Vajrapāṇi in a particular epithet form. The Tibetan reads gzhon nu rdo rje sde, which could be read as "the youthful Vajra-host" or as a proper epithet of Vajrapāṇi as leader of the vajra assembly. The doctrinal import is clear regardless.

The liberation from "birth as a woman" reflects a conventional Mahāyāna aspiration found in several sūtra and dhāraṇī contexts, where taking rebirth as a woman is classified as a disadvantageous condition for practice; this is a standard doctrinal usage and not an editorial judgment.

- The phrase rendered "realm of the meteor-stone" translates skar rdo'i rgyal srid, literally "meteor-stone kingdom," which is an unusual toponym or epithet whose precise referent is not identifiable from the passage alone; it may be a proper place name or a title.

The phrase "land of Li" renders li yul, which in Tibetan literature most commonly refers to Khotan (ancient Kustana); it is left as "land of Li" since "Li" is its standard Tibetan name and the geographic identification, while traditionally Khotan, is not explicitly stated in the text itself.

The "dhāraṇī of Stable Horse" renders rta gnas kyi gzungs sngags, literally "the dhāraṇī mantra of the one who remains on a horse" or "Stable-in-the-Saddle"; the exact deity or figure bearing this epithet is not identified within this passage.

- The Tathāgata epithets in the homage series follow a pattern built around "rnam par snang

byed" — literally "the one who makes all appear distinctly" — a standard epithet of Vairocana. The series here presents a sequence of titles expanding upon that name rather than uniformly naming the same buddha, so they are rendered descriptively. The precise Sanskrit equivalents of these extended epithets are reconstructed from the Tibetan rather than drawn from a confirmed Sanskrit source.

The mantra transliteration preserves the syllables as given in the Tibetan, which appear to be phonetic renderings of Sanskrit; exact Sanskrit reconstruction is uncertain in several syllables.

- The plant names in the medicinal recipe are transliterated Tibetan rendering of what are likely Sanskrit or local pharmacological terms. Several remain unidentifiable with certainty: srā-tree resin, jamāka, sughaṅga, āvayak, and "the crystal plant" (pu shel tse) are rendered as best approximations. The "Horse Station vidyā mantra" (rta gnas kyi rig sngags) likely refers to a specific ritual formula named earlier in the text that is not recoverable from this passage alone.

- The series of epithets beginning "the lord of the lordly devas, the sovereign king of trees, the lord of compassion Thāskar" and so on appears to be a list of divine or semi-divine beings who are named associates of Avalokiteśvara. "Thāskar" is a Tibetan rendering of what is likely a proper name; the underlying Sanskrit is uncertain. "Mahābalavāpta" is a standard rendering of མཐོག་འཕེལ་བཟུང་།. The epithet "the bodhisattva who acts as a great elephant" for འཇམ་མཐོག་འཕེལ་བཟུང་། is literal; this may be an epithet of a specific bodhisattva whose identity is not otherwise established in this passage. The dhāraṇī syllables are transliterated as they appear; some phonetic variation from standard Sanskrit is expected in such tantric formulae.

- The passage contains an embedded narrative about Avalokiteśvara appearing as an old brahmin to comfort a blind and leprous woman at the city gate. The proper name "Ocean-Dust" (ཕྱུང་ཕྱུང་འཕྲུལ་པ་) is a rendering of a brahmin's name and is kept as a meaningful translation rather than transliteration, as no Sanskrit equivalent is supplied in the text. The phrase rendered "stable abiding" (འཇགས་འཇགས་) at the opening is likely a named mantra or vidyā category from the preceding untranslated material; its precise referent is uncertain from context alone. The sentence ending "the brahmin who was skillfully revealing the Buddha to that woman" is grammatically incomplete in the source, indicating the passage continues.

- The "sky-like words" of Maitreya renders a phrase meaning the bodhisattva's teaching as vast and unobstructed as the sky; this is likely a reference to a specific doctrinal formulation or text attributed to Maitreya, and the parenthetical gloss conveys its sense for the listener.

The name "Huśa" is a transliteration of the Tibetan phonetic rendering of what may be a Sanskrit or Central Asian name; no standard Sanskrit reconstruction is certain.

The phrase rendered "stars and those of the golden lineage" is somewhat cryptic in context and may refer to a cosmological or genealogical classification system specific to this text; its precise meaning is genuinely uncertain.

- The Tathāgata's name in the source is a compound of several elements: Padma, Vimala, Nakṣatrarāja, Abhijñā, and Puṣpavikasita or similar. The translation renders these descriptive elements in sequence as they appear. The precise canonical Sanskrit equivalent of this buddha's name is uncertain and would require collation with a Sanskrit source text.

The name Ogpakchen is a transliteration of the Tibetan འོག་པ་ཅན་; a Sanskrit equivalent is not recoverable from the passage alone and so it is retained as a proper name.

- The term rendered "samādhi on impurity" translates mi gtsang ba'i ting nge 'dzin, which refers to the meditation on the foul or impure (Skt. aśubhabhāvanā) as a formal contemplative practice. The aspiration here is that grief over impermanence will become the gateway to this meditation. This is a doctrinally specific and somewhat unusual formulation worth noting.

The passage identifying Maitreya as dwelling in "Dga' Idan" (Tuṣṭita heaven) is standard Mahāyāna doctrine; the Tibetan name Dga' Idan is the conventional rendering of Tuṣṭita, retained here in English.

The phrase rendered "Crystal King" for skar rdo'i rgyal po is a translation of a proper name meaning "king of crystal" or "king of precious stone," not a title in the usual sense; consistency with the preceding passage's usage is maintained.

- The names Śubhākara ("virtuous-doer," literally "maker of good") and Pāpakara ("evil-doer," literally "maker of evil") are Tibetan renderings of Sanskrit names and have been reconstructed accordingly. Similarly, Vijayakīrti ("glory of victory"), Vijayayaśas ("fame of victory"), and Vijayavarmā ("armor of victory") are restored from the transparent Tibetan. Īśvaravarmā is restored from the Tibetan spelling of the Meteor Stone king's name. The "Red-Faces" is a standard Tibetan designation for the Tibetan armies or a neighboring people with that epithet; the referent may be historically specific to the narrative context of this text. The term rendered "gathering" for མཇུག་ཁྲིའི་ is somewhat unusual; it may refer to a military or political assembly coming to Li, and this reading follows contextual inference.
- The phrase rendered "the patience" refers to a specific attainment on the bodhisattva path, the patience or forbearance with respect to the non-arising of phenomena (anutpattikadharmakṣānti), a significant doctrinal milestone. The text's grammar here is compressed, and this is the most contextually appropriate reading.

The identity and role of "the Red-Faced Ones" (Tibetan: *gdong dmar*) is not explained in the passage itself; this appears to be a reference to a specific group relevant to the prophecy's historical or eschatological context, and the term is rendered literally throughout as it functions as a proper designation in the narrative.

- The epithet rendered "king of the unmoving mind who pacifies harm" translates *mi gnas pa'i blo'i rgyal po gnod pa zhi bar mdzad pa*. The "unmoving mind" here likely refers to a specific buddha-name meaning something like "King of Immovable Intellect, Pacifier of Harm" — this may be a proper buddha-name rather than a purely descriptive epithet, but the Tibetan is rendered as given.

The phrase "queen sovereign of qualities, moving like a vajra" renders rdo rje ltar 'gro ba yon tan gyi dbang phyug rgyal mo, which is notably feminine in Tibetan. This may reflect a buddha-name that is grammatically or iconographically feminine, which is unusual in this list context; the Tibetan is followed faithfully.

The mantra syllables are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic rendering and do not necessarily represent a fully reliable Sanskrit reconstruction.

- The phrase rendered "harmonious patience" translates a term that can also mean "acquiescent patience" or "patience of acceptance," referring to a stage of doctrinal acceptance in the bodhisattva path. The present rendering follows the contextual pattern of the series.

The final sentence breaks off mid-phrase in the Tibetan, ending at "ties a cord," indicating the passage is incomplete; the continuation follows in the next section.

- The mantra syllables throughout are transliterated from Tibetan phonetic approximations of Sanskrit or quasi-Sanskrit dhāraṇī syllables and are rendered here in roman transliteration matching the Tibetan phonetic spelling, as is standard for dhāraṇī texts of this kind.

The term rendered "white sugar" for श्वेतकण्टारि literally means "white karka," likely referring to sugar candy or rock sugar used in Ayurvedic eye preparations.

- The narrative section that begins "there will come a time when robbers arrive" is part of a past-life or prophetic story embedded within the text, illustrating the karmic consequences of

the events described. The abrupt shift in register from instruction to narrative is present in the Tibetan and is reproduced faithfully here.

The phrase rendered "those with red faces seize the land" refers to an enemy invasion described by the physical characteristic of red-faced warriors; this is likely a reference to a specific historical or legendary enemy force. The text does not name them further at this point.

- The name rendered "Aprāpā" translates literally as "one who takes away" or "the abductor woman"; the Tibetan འཔྲཱཔ་ is a proper name used consistently in this narrative and has been rendered accordingly. The associated form འཔྲཱཔ་ལྔ་པ་ means "Aprāpā's son" or "Aprāpā with her son," and the phrase འཔྲཱཔ་ལྔ་པ་ལྔ་པ་ means "together with her child or children." The name Vimalaprabhā, translating འཕྲིལ་པ་ལྔ་པ་, means "Stainless Light" and appears here for the first time as a speaker.
- The name "Tsaminda" is a transliteration of མཚུངས་པ་, which does not correspond to a clearly identified Sanskrit toponym in the standard corpus; it is rendered phonetically here. The "Suma" (མུ་མ་) is similarly an unidentified group or people mentioned as invaders; it is transliterated. "Dupāla and Akuna" (ཏུཔ་ལ་འཁུ་) are proper names whose identities are not established in the surrounding context and are likewise rendered phonetically. The king "Āryajāta" (འཕྲེལ་ཇཱ་ཏཱ་) is a standard Tibetan rendering of that Sanskrit name, associated in Buddhist historical literature with the Licchavis or adjacent traditions; the reference to his campaign against the Śākya is a well-known narrative element. The "great stūpa of the noble Aśva" (འཕྲེལ་ཇཱ་ཏཱ་ལྔ་པ་ལྔ་པ་) is an otherwise unidentified stūpa referred to by this name in the text; "Aśva" is retained as a Sanskrit name.
- The name rendered "Certainty" translates འཕྲིལ་པ་, which functions here as a personal name for the monk or figure who has been receiving these instructions; it is consistent with the narrative context.

The mantra syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan, which presents Sanskrit phonemes in Tibetan script with some orthographic variation; no attempt has been made to normalize them, as dhāraṇī syllables are conventionally preserved as received.

The phrase འཕྲེལ་ཇཱ་ཏཱ་ལྔ་པ་ is literally "at the time of the sesame-flour offering" and refers to a ritual flour-offering ceremony; this is a recognized liturgical context for mantra recitation and has been rendered accordingly.

The phrase འཕྲེལ་ཇཱ་ཏཱ་ rendered "open the way" is a significant instruction to Avalokiteśvara; it could also mean "create an opportunity" or "make the occasion available," and the precise action it entails may be clarified by the broader narrative context.

- The series of Tathāgata names prefixed with "chos" are rendered by their Tibetan semantic content into approximate Sanskrit equivalents for clarity; no Sanskrit equivalents are attested in the passage itself. The name "Dharmastūpa" for chos brtsegs renders the sense of "piled up / stacked Dharma" which approximates a stupa image. The rendering of "red-faced ones" for gdong dmar dag is kept literal; this likely refers to Tibetan forces or a specific invading group, and the referent is genuinely uncertain. The phrase "meteor-king Vijayanātha" renders skar rdo'i rgyal po rnam par rgyal ba'i go cha: literally "the armor of the victorious meteor-king," which may refer to a specific celestial or ritual weapon-concept; the precise referent is uncertain.
- The name "Rab-ngé" appears to be a personal name (possibly a practitioner or deity-epithet in the context of this particular sādhana tradition) left untranslated as it functions as a proper name throughout. Its Sanskrit equivalent, if any, is not recoverable from context alone.

The list of epithets applied to Avalokiteśvara — "Lord of Lords," "King Lord of the Forest," "Lord of the Radiance of Renunciation," "Lord of Gandharvas," and so forth — are titles of

bodhisattvas attending or identified with Avalokiteśvara in this maṇḍala context. The Tibetan term "dBang-phyug" (Skt. Īśvara, "lord") recurs as a component throughout, and each phrase names a distinct attendant figure or aspect.

The mantra syllables are transliterated as faithfully as the Tibetan orthography allows; they represent a liturgical dhāraṇī and are not translated.

- The term rendered "land of the golden family" translates འཕགས་པོའི་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ཡུལ་, which is a technical designation whose precise referent is uncertain in this context — it may denote a specific pure land, a geographical region, or a ritual category. The passage འཕགས་པོའི་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ཡུལ་ "rite of the golden lotus" similarly appears to refer to a specific ritual whose full context is given elsewhere in the larger text. The term འཕགས་པོའི་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ཡུལ་ rendered "the land of Mañcalī under the seal" is also uncertain; this may be a transcription of a Sanskrit place name or ritual designation that remains partially opaque.
- The passage involves several textual repetitions that appear intentional in the original, describing a parallel sequence of events. The name rendered "Radiance of Stainless Light" translates the epithet Dri ma med pa'i 'od las rab nges, which also seems to be identified with Subhūti in context; the doubling of the prophecy passage is in the Tibetan itself.

The Tathāgata "Dri ma med pa'i dpal tsan dan gyi snying po" (Vimalakīrti Candana-sāra) is a somewhat unusual buddha name; this rendering follows the literal Tibetan meaning. The identification with the Vimalakīrti of the famous sūtra is not certain and is not asserted here.

- The passage contains a dense network of past-life narrative with several proper names that are likely phonological transcriptions of Sanskrit or local terms. "Rūpasāra" renders རུཔ་སྤུལ་ཤར་པ་ literally as "King Essence-of-Form" and a Sanskrit equivalent Rūpasāra is plausible but not attested here independently. "Citybeautiful" renders རྩེ་ལྷ་མོ་, which is a descriptive epithet used as a monk's name; it may correspond to a Sanskrit name like Nagararāmya or similar but no Sanskrit original is given in the text. "Brave Nurture" renders རྩེ་ལྷ་མོ་, a name whose Sanskrit original is uncertain. "Red-Faced Ones" renders རྩེ་ལྷ་མོ་, a term for a group identified elsewhere in this text as a foreign or tribal people, likely referring to a specific ethnic group; the translation follows the literal rendering as used in the preceding passage. The phrase rendered "charged against her account" represents an idiomatic karmic accounting notion in the original.
- The "Droṇa Gotra" passage refers to the brahmin Droṇa of the Droṇa clan, the figure from the Mahāparinirvāṇa narrative who divided the Buddha Śākyamuni's relics among the claimant kingdoms. The Tibetan "འབྲོ་ན་གཏཱ་ལཱ་མེད་" is a phonetic rendering of the Sanskrit personal name Droṇa and the clan designation gotra; "Droṇa Gotra" is retained here as a proper name. This is a significant doctrinal claim identifying Droṇa the relic-divider as a past and future manifestation of Mañjuśrī.

The phrase rendered "wild men" (རྩེ་ལྷ་མོ་) literally means "fierce/savage men" or "barbarians"; the translation "wild men" preserves the sense of untamed, uncivilized persons operating outside the social order, which the context requires.

- The phrase "red faces" is a conventional Tibetan reference to Tibetan peoples and by extension may signal a specific prophetic context concerning Tibet; the term is left as rendered since it is clear in context. "Gośṛṅga, Gomasāla, and Gandhā" are stūpa names reconstructed from the Tibetan; the last, rendered from "ga n dha," is tentative as the Tibetan transliteration is ambiguous. "The land of Li" appears throughout as a specific toponym, likely referring to a region in Central Asia (Khotan is sometimes identified with this term), treated as a proper name throughout.
- The phrase rendered "the youth Vajra, Vajra-host" reflects an ambiguity in the Tibetan, which uses both "rdo rje gzhon nu" (youth Vajra, or young Vajra) and "rdo rje sde" (Vajra-host) as

apparently two distinct names or epithets referring to individuals connected with the protection of the land of Li; they appear to be the same figure named differently, or two closely associated figures. The translation preserves the ambiguity as it stands in the text.

The dhāraṇī syllables are rendered in approximate Sanskrit transliteration as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic rendering; the Sanskrit underlying some syllables is uncertain, and the transliteration here reflects the most plausible reconstruction rather than a critically established Sanskrit text.

- The buddha-name rendered "Abundantly Blooming Flowers of Omniscient Knowledge, King of Stars, Unstained Petal of the Lotus" is a long compound Tibetan epithet for a single buddha of a distant pure land. The rendering is literal and faithful to the Tibetan, though the Sanskrit original of this name is not recoverable from context alone.

The name Huśa is a Tibetan phonetic rendering of a foreign proper name; its Sanskrit or other original form is uncertain.

- The place names Dngarldan, Rtā 'jug, 'Gumti, Rtsa rma ba na ra, and Pāyādika are rendered in transliteration as they appear to be specific topographical or settlement names within the narrative's world, likely corresponding to historical sites in the Li (Khotan) region. Their identification with specific historical locations is uncertain and has been left for scholarly apparatus rather than the translation body.

The term "Li" throughout refers to the kingdom of Khotan (Li yul), a historically significant Buddhist kingdom in Central Asia. This is a well-established identification in Tibetan literature.

The phrase rendered as "great serpents" translates lto 'phyen chen po, literally "great belly-crawlers," a term for a class of powerful serpentine beings distinct from nāgas; the rendering follows the contextual sense within the traditional cosmological list.

- The place names Karadu and Li are obscure. "Karadu" renders skar rdo, literally "stone star" or possibly a transliteration of a foreign toponym; "Li" renders li yul, a term sometimes identified with Khotan or a region of Central Asia. The exact identification of both remains uncertain but is not critical to the meaning of the passage.

The dhāraṇī syllables are transcribed from the Tibetan phonetic rendering as faithfully as possible. These are clearly Indic-origin mantras transmitted through Tibetan transliteration; the spellings do not always permit confident Sanskrit reconstruction, so they are given here as found.

The phrase rendered "the gods will be unable to obstruct it" could also be read as "the gods will be unable to curse it" or "harm it by divine agency," but the sense of divine interference being blocked is consistent across the passage.

- The land of Lī refers to Khotan, the historical Central Asian kingdom; this is well-established in scholarship on this text. The passage is from a sūtra associated with the protection of Khotan, known in Tibetan as the Khotanese royal prophecy literature. Mahāśvara here is the great lord Śiva in his Indic form. Haritī is the goddess of children and protector, known in Sanskrit as Hārītī. "Garuḍas" render nam mkha' lding, literally sky-soaring; "mahoragas" render lto 'phyen chen po, great belly-crawlers or great serpents. Sarvajayin renders kun tu rgyal ba, "all-victorious." The phrase "deceive the body" in the solemn oath is a stock formula of binding self-imprecation in this genre.

- The passage contains a series of epithets rendered as "sovereign of X" — the Tibetan uses "dbang phyug" (meaning "lord" or "sovereign") compounded with various nouns. These appear to be names or titles of particular divine beings in the narrative's cosmological retinue, and they are rendered descriptively as the text itself presents them rather than as proper Sanskrit names, since no Sanskrit equivalents are established in the available context.

The name "Dharmatīra" renders "dar ma ti ra," which appears to be a transliteration of a Sanskrit place-name or temple-name; the exact Sanskrit form is uncertain.

"Rabnge" renders "rab nges," which functions here as a name or epithet the divine goddess will bear in the land of Lī; its meaning is something like "thoroughly certain" or "fully assured."

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source; the translation reflects this.

- The "Li region" appears several times as a place name associated with the entrustment. This is likely a specific geographical or cosmological region (perhaps Khotan, known in Tibetan as Li yul), and it is left as "Li region" to maintain consistency with what appears to be an established technical term in this text.

The goddess Vimalaprabā literally means "stainless light" or "immaculate radiance," but as she has been introduced by the epithet "goddess of stainless light" earlier in the preceding context, the Sanskrit name is here retained as Vimalaprabā for consistency.

The phrase rendered "the lord of secrets" for gSang ba'i bdag po is a standard epithet of Vajrapāṇi in Mahāyāna literature.

- The "third fruit" rendered here is a reference to the third of the four fruits of the śrāvaka path, namely non-returning (anāgāmin). The passage uses this attainment as a yardstick for the merit of studying this sūtra, a rhetorical device common in merit-comparison passages of Mahāyāna sūtras.

The vow formula — that if the pledge is broken, the assembled beings will have deceived the bodies of the buddhas of the three times and committed sins of uninterrupted gravity (ānantarya) — is a solemn oath-of-witness structure characteristic of this genre; the assembled beings are invoking the most severe possible karmic consequence as a guarantee of their pledge.

The title dharmamūrdhan ("Crown of the Dharma") rendered as "Crown of the Dharma" is a common Mahāyāna sūtra epithet connoting supremacy or apex of the Dharma.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.